BAYVIEW WARD · WILMINGTON DELAWARE STAKE

Storehouse Meal Planner Recipe Book

Version V23

All 302 recipes

Amounts as written; each recipe shows how many servings it makes
Made November 2, 2026

Please read before you cook
Nutrition, calories and serving sizes in this book are estimates. Diet labels are a guide only. Estimated costs use estimated October 2026 store prices for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children and are for planning purposes only. The next pages explain how servings, calories and costs are figured and what to check for allergies and special diets.

Not an official Church publication. Prepared by local volunteers as a free resource.

Nutrition, serving sizes, calories and costs

How nutrition is estimated

Each recipe's nutrition comes from typical package nutrition labels for its ingredients, added up and divided by the number of servings the recipe makes as written. Water and optional toppings are not counted.

Added sugar counts the sugar, syrup, honey, jam, boxed mixes and sweetened canned foods in a recipe. Natural sugar in fruit and milk is not counted as added sugar.

Brands, portion sizes and cooking methods change the real numbers, so treat every figure as an estimate.

What a serving is

One serving is one adult serving: the finished dish divided by the number of servings the recipe makes. A recipe that makes 4 servings, cut into 4 equal portions, gives 4 adult servings.

Other ages get a share of an adult serving: teens (13-18) about 1.1 servings, children (4-12) about 3/4 of a serving, and toddlers (1-3) about 1/2 of a serving. The planner uses these same shares to size every meal and the order, so a household of 1 adult and 3 teens needs 4.3 servings per meal.

These shares are planning averages. Growing teens, active people and small eaters may need more or less, so adjust portions to each person's appetite.

Babies under 1 year are not included. Follow your pediatrician's advice for infant feeding.

Who	Ages	Share of an adult serving	Typical calories per day
Adults	19+	1 serving	1,600–3,000
Teens	13–18	1.1 servings	1,800–3,200
Children	4–12	3/4 serving	1,200–2,600
Toddlers	1–3	1/2 serving	about 1,000–1,400

About the calories

Calories on each recipe are for one portion of that dish for each age, not for a whole day.

Typical daily calorie needs from the Dietary Guidelines for Americans, from less active to very active: adults (19+) 1,600–3,000; teens (13–18) 1,800–3,200; children (4–12) 1,200–2,600; toddlers (1–3) about 1,000–1,400. Needs vary with age, size, sex and activity, and during pregnancy or breastfeeding.

If anyone in the household has a medical diet, such as for diabetes, kidney disease or heart disease, check portions with their doctor or a dietitian.

Diet labels and allergies

Nutrition information is an estimate based on typical package values and will vary with brands, portion sizes and preparation. Gluten-free, dairy-free, vegetarian and vegan labels are a guide only: check every ingredient label and confirm a recipe is safe for you before eating, especially for food allergies or celiac disease.

Recipes marked gluten-free, dairy-free, vegetarian or vegan are labeled from their usual ingredients. Store brands differ, so read every label, especially for celiac disease or food allergies.

For toddlers and young children, cut grapes and hot dogs into small pieces and skip popcorn. These are choking risks.

About the estimated costs

Each recipe shows an estimated cost for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children, which is 4.6 adult servings. The cost is for planning purposes only. It is not a price quote, and it is not what the storehouse charges: items from the bishops' storehouse are provided at no cost to the family.

Prices are estimates as of October 2026: what the ingredients would cost at a Walmart-type store in the Northeast, based on Bureau of Labor Statistics average prices (September 2026) and Walmart prices in October 2026. Prices change over time, so costs after October 2026 may be different. If you changed any prices on the Shopping list tab, the book uses your prices.

Only the part of each package the recipe uses is counted. You may have to buy whole packages, and prices change by

store, brand, sale and week. Most groceries are not taxed in Maryland, Delaware or Pennsylvania, so no tax is added.

Lower sodium and lower sugar

The Storehouse Meal Planner has two Modify recipes switches. Lower sodium cuts added salt and bouillon in half, cuts soy sauce, tamari and taco seasoning by a third, and drains and rinses canned beans and vegetables. Lower sugar cuts sugar, brown sugar, powdered sugar, syrup, honey and jam by a third. Boxed cake, brownie, pudding and gelatin mixes can't be changed, so serve smaller portions of those instead.

This book was made with lower sodium off and lower sugar off. Amounts and nutrition are for the recipes as written. Recipes with salty or sweet ingredients include a short tip on how to cut back.

A recipe is marked Lower-sodium pick when one serving has no more sodium than the planner's cutoff for its meal type (mg per serving: breakfasts 700, lunches 900, dinners 900, side dishes 350, snacks 300, desserts 300), and Lower-sugar pick when it has no more added sugar than the cutoff (grams per serving: breakfasts 12, lunches 8, dinners 10, side dishes 6, snacks 10, desserts 24). These are the same cutoffs the planner uses to hide the saltiest and most sugary recipes. Both lists are at the end of the book.

For comparison, the FDA's Daily Value is 2,300 mg of sodium and 50 g of added sugars a day for adults and children 4 and older. The cutoffs and picks are planning guides, not medical advice; follow your doctor's guidance for a prescribed low-sodium or diabetic diet.

Ingredients and amounts

Ingredient amounts are for the recipe as written. To cook for more or fewer people, scale every amount by the same factor.

An asterisk (*) marks an ingredient that is not on the Bishop's Order for Food and Supplies; buy it separately or swap it out.

Recipes are shown at full size in this book. Scale-down settings in the planner (5% to 20% smaller) apply to your meal plan and order, not to the amounts or costs in this book.

Orders from the bishops' storehouse must be approved by the bishop, through the elders quorum presidency or the Relief Society presidency.

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Breakfasts

Apple-cinnamon oatmeal

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Creamy oats simmered with tender apple, warm cinnamon and plump raisins, like apple pie in a bowl.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2 cups milk, plus 2 cups water
- 1 apple, diced
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- ¼ cup raisins
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Bring the milk, water, salt and apple to a boil.
2. Stir in the oats and simmer 5 minutes, stirring.
3. Stir in cinnamon, brown sugar and raisins.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 319 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 351 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 239 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 159 cal

Per adult serving: 319 cal · 9 g protein · 61 g carbs · 5 g fat · 6 g fiber · 137 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.46 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.54 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Baked oatmeal

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Golden, cake-like oatmeal squares with cinnamon and raisins, crisp at the edges and soft inside.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cups rolled oats
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ½ tsp salt
- 2 eggs
- 1½ cups milk
- 4 Tbsp butter, melted
- ½ cup raisins

Steps

1. Mix the dry ingredients; whisk in eggs, milk and butter; add raisins.
2. Pour into a greased 8x8 pan. Refrigerate overnight if you like.
3. Bake at 350°F for 35–40 minutes, until set. Cut into squares.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 384 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 422 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 288 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 192 cal

Per adult serving: 384 cal · 10 g protein · 59 g carbs · 13 g fat · 5 g fiber · 394 mg sodium · 18 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.48 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.54 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Banana bread

Dessert, Snack, Breakfast · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Moist, tender banana bread with a golden, caramelized crust.

Makes 10 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- ¼ tsp salt
- 8 Tbsp butter, melted
- ¾ cup brown sugar
- 2 eggs
- 3 bananas, mashed
- 1 tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Mix butter, brown sugar, eggs, banana and vanilla.
2. Stir in flour, baking soda and salt just until combined.
3. Bake in a greased loaf pan at 350°F for 55–60 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 282 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 310 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 211 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 141 cal

Per adult serving: 282 cal · 4 g protein · 43 g carbs · 10 g fat · 2 g fiber · 275 mg sodium · 16 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.46 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.32 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Banana muffins

Breakfast, Snack, Dessert · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Moist, tender banana muffins with a hint of cinnamon, great warm or on the go.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- ½ cup sugar
- 1 tsp baking soda
- ½ tsp salt
- 3 bananas, mashed
- 1 egg
- 5 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- ½ tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Mix flour, sugar, baking soda, salt and cinnamon.
2. Stir in banana, egg, oil and vanilla just until combined.
3. Divide into 12 greased muffin cups; bake at 350°F for 20 minutes. Serving = 2 muffins.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 383 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 421 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 287 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 192 cal

Per adult serving: 383 cal · 6 g protein · 62 g carbs · 13 g fat · 3 g fiber · 415 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.48 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.32 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Banana-cinnamon pancakes

Breakfast, Dinner · Vegetarian

Tender pancakes folded with mashed banana and cinnamon for a sweet, bakery-style breakfast.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cups pancake mix
- 2 bananas, mashed
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¾ cup pancake syrup
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Mix pancake batter per the box; fold in mashed banana and cinnamon.
2. Cook ¼ cup at a time on a hot oiled griddle, flipping when bubbles form.
3. Serve with syrup.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 602 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 662 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 451 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 301 cal

Per adult serving: 602 cal · 10 g protein · 125 g carbs · 8 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,178 mg sodium · 36 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.50 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.54 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Biscuits and sausage gravy

Breakfast, Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Flaky homemade biscuits smothered in creamy, peppery sausage gravy.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2¼ cups flour, 2 cups for biscuits, ¼ cup for gravy
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 6 Tbsp butter, cold
- 3¾ cups milk, ¾ cup for biscuits, 3 cups for gravy
- 1 lb pork sausage
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Biscuits: mix 2 cups flour, baking powder and salt; cut in butter; stir in ¾ cup milk. Pat ¾ inch thick, cut, bake at 450°F for 10–12 minutes.
2. Gravy: brown sausage without draining; sprinkle in ¼ cup flour and stir 1 minute.
3. Slowly stir in 3 cups milk; simmer until thick. Season with pepper and spoon over split biscuits.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 851 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 936 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 638 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 425 cal

Per adult serving: 851 cal · 30 g protein · 66 g carbs · 51 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,887 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.67 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.67 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Breakfast burritos

Breakfast, Dinner, Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Fluffy eggs, savory sausage, peppers and melted cheese rolled into warm tortillas.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ½ lb pork sausage
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- ½ onion, diced
- 8 eggs
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 8 flour tortillas
- ½ cup salsa

Steps

1. Brown sausage with pepper and onion; drain.
2. Add beaten eggs; scramble until just set.
3. Fill tortillas with egg mixture and cheese; roll up. Serve with salsa.
4. To freeze: wrap in foil; reheat unwrapped in a paper towel 2 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 722 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 794 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 542 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 361 cal

Per adult serving: 722 cal · 36 g protein · 54 g carbs · 40 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,592 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.17 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.21 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chewy granola bars

Snack, Breakfast · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Soft, chewy homemade granola bars with peanut butter, honey and raisins.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2½ cups rolled oats
- 8 Tbsp honey
- 8 Tbsp peanut butter
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- ½ cup raisins
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1 tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Warm honey, peanut butter and brown sugar until smooth; stir in vanilla and salt.
2. Stir in oats and raisins; press firmly into a lined 8x8 pan.
3. Chill 2 hours; cut into 12 bars.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.
To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 207 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 228 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 155 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 104 cal

Per adult serving: 207 cal · 5 g protein · 35 g carbs · 6 g fat · 3 g fiber · 98 mg sodium · 16 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.60 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.35 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cinnamon breakfast rice

Breakfast · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Creamy rice simmered in milk with cinnamon, vanilla and raisins.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cup rice (uncooked)
- 3 cups milk
- ¼ cup raisins
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer rice in 2 cups water, covered, 15 minutes.
2. Stir in milk, raisins, cinnamon, brown sugar and salt; simmer 10 minutes, stirring.
3. Stir in vanilla.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.
To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 350 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 385 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 262 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 175 cal

Per adult serving: 350 cal · 10 g protein · 69 g carbs · 4 g fat · 1 g fiber · 166 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.02 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.44 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cinnamon French toast sticks

Breakfast, Snack · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Crispy French toast sticks rolled in cinnamon sugar for dipping in syrup.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 slices white bread, cut in 3 strips each
- 4 eggs
- ¾ cup milk
- 2 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3 Tbsp butter
- ½ cup pancake syrup

Steps

1. Whisk eggs, milk, vanilla and 1 tsp cinnamon.
2. Dip bread strips; cook in butter 2 minutes per side.
3. Roll hot sticks in the rest of the cinnamon mixed with sugar. Serve with syrup for dipping.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 481 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 529 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 361 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 240 cal

Per adult serving: 481 cal · 13 g protein · 71 g carbs · 16 g fat · 2 g fiber · 474 mg sodium · 37 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.24 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.71 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cinnamon rolls

Dessert, Breakfast · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Soft, fluffy homemade cinnamon rolls with sweet, gooey glaze.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4½ cups flour
- 1 pack yeast
- 1¼ cups milk
- ½ cup sugar
- 12 Tbsp butter
- 1 egg
- 1 tsp salt
- ¾ cup brown sugar
- 2 tsp cinnamon
- 1 cup powdered sugar

Steps

1. Dissolve yeast in 1 cup warm milk with the sugar; mix in 4 Tbsp melted butter, egg, salt and flour; knead 6 minutes; rise 1 hour.
2. Roll to 12x18 inches; spread with 6 Tbsp soft butter, brown sugar and cinnamon; roll up and cut 12.
3. Rise 30 minutes in a 9x13 pan; bake at 350°F for 25 minutes.
4. Glaze with powdered sugar, 2 Tbsp milk and 2 Tbsp melted butter.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 416 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 458 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 312 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 208 cal

Per adult serving: 416 cal · 7 g protein · 69 g carbs · 13 g fat · 1 g fiber · 304 mg sodium · 31 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.68 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cottage cheese and fruit plate

Breakfast, Lunch, Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Cool, creamy cottage cheese with juicy peaches and fresh grapes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups cottage cheese
- 1 can canned peaches, drained
- 1 cup grapes

Steps

1. Divide cottage cheese into bowls or containers; top with peaches and grapes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 286 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 315 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 215 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 143 cal

Per adult serving: 286 cal · 14 g protein · 48 g carbs · 5 g fat · 2 g fiber · 423 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.23 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.57 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cottage cheese pancakes

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Light, tender cottage cheese pancakes with raspberry jam.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cup cottage cheese
- 4 eggs
- ½ cup flour
- 3 tsp sugar
- ¼ tsp salt
- 2 Tbsp butter
- 4 Tbsp raspberry jam

Steps

1. Whisk cottage cheese and eggs; stir in flour, sugar and salt.
2. Cook small pancakes in butter 2–3 minutes per side.
3. Serve with raspberry jam.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.
To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 296 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 326 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 222 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 148 cal

Per adult serving: 296 cal · 14 g protein · 30 g carbs · 13 g fat · 0 g fiber · 469 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.48 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.76 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free apple-cinnamon oatmeal

Breakfast · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick

Creamy apple-cinnamon oatmeal with raisins, made with plant milk.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2 cups soy or oat milk, plus 2 cups water *
- 1 apple, diced
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- ¼ cup raisins
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Bring plant milk, water, salt and apple to a boil.
2. Stir in oats; simmer 5 minutes, stirring.
3. Stir in cinnamon, brown sugar and raisins.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.
To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 298 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 328 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 223 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 149 cal

Per adult serving: 298 cal · 9 g protein · 57 g carbs · 5 g fat · 6 g fiber · 125 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.92 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.63 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free baked oatmeal

Breakfast · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Golden, cinnamon-raisin baked oatmeal squares made without butter or milk.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cups rolled oats
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ½ tsp salt
- 2 eggs
- 1½ cups soy or oat milk *
- 4 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ cup raisins

Steps

1. Mix the dry ingredients; whisk in eggs, plant milk and oil; add raisins.
2. Pour into a greased 8x8 pan.
3. Bake at 350°F for 35–40 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 385 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 424 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 289 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 193 cal

Per adult serving: 385 cal · 9 g protein · 57 g carbs · 15 g fat · 5 g fiber · 328 mg sodium · 18 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.47 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.54 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free banana bread

Dessert, Snack, Breakfast · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Moist, sweet banana bread made with oil instead of butter.

Makes 10 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- ¼ tsp salt
- 6 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¾ cup brown sugar
- 2 eggs
- 3 bananas, mashed
- 1 tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Mix oil, brown sugar, eggs, banana and vanilla.
2. Stir in flour, baking soda and salt.
3. Bake in a greased loaf pan at 350°F for 55–60 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 272 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 300 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 204 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 136 cal

Per adult serving: 272 cal · 4 g protein · 43 g carbs · 10 g fat · 2 g fiber · 203 mg sodium · 16 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.11 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.24 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free biscuits and sausage gravy

Breakfast, Dinner · Dairy-free · Lower-sugar pick

Tender drop biscuits under creamy, peppery sausage gravy, all without dairy.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2¼ cups flour, 2 cups for biscuits, ¼ cup for gravy
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 5 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 3¾ cups soy or oat milk, ¾ cup for biscuits, 3 cups for gravy *
- 1 lb pork sausage
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Biscuits: mix 2 cups flour, baking powder and salt; stir in oil and ¾ cup plant milk; drop by spoonfuls; bake at 450°F for 12 minutes.
2. Gravy: brown sausage without draining; stir in ¼ cup flour for 1 minute.
3. Slowly add 3 cups plant milk; simmer until thick; season with pepper.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 808 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 889 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 606 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 404 cal

Per adult serving: 808 cal · 29 g protein · 58 g carbs · 51 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,729 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.92 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.72 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free breakfast burritos

Breakfast, Dinner, Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Eggs, sausage, potatoes and peppers wrapped in warm tortillas with salsa.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ½ lb pork sausage
- 1 potato, diced small
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- ½ onion, diced
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 8 eggs
- 8 flour tortillas
- ¾ cup salsa

Steps

1. Cook potato in oil, covered, 8 minutes; add sausage, pepper and onion and brown; drain.
2. Add beaten eggs; scramble until just set.
3. Fill tortillas with filling and salsa; roll up. Freeze extras in foil.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 683 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 751 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 512 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 341 cal

Per adult serving: 683 cal · 30 g protein · 64 g carbs · 35 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,533 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.42 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.05 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free French toast

Breakfast, Dinner · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Golden French toast soaked in vanilla-cinnamon custard made with plant milk.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 eggs
- 1 cup soy or oat milk *
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 12 slices white bread
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¾ cup pancake syrup

Steps

1. Whisk eggs, plant milk, cinnamon and vanilla.
2. Dip bread about 5 seconds per side.
3. Cook on an oiled griddle over medium heat, 2–3 minutes per side.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 575 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 633 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 431 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 288 cal

Per adult serving: 575 cal · 19 g protein · 84 g carbs · 18 g fat · 3 g fiber · 600 mg sodium · 36 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.15 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.90 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free potato and egg hash

Breakfast, Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy potatoes, peppers and onions topped with soft-set eggs and salsa.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 potatoes, diced small
- 1 onion, diced
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 8 eggs
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook potatoes in oil, covered, 10 minutes, stirring often.
2. Add onion and pepper; cook uncovered until browned. Season.
3. Make 8 wells, crack in eggs, cover and cook 5 minutes. Serve with salsa.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 392 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 431 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 294 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 196 cal

Per adult serving: 392 cal · 18 g protein · 44 g carbs · 17 g fat · 6 g fiber · 668 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.56 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.43 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Egg and cheese sandwiches

Breakfast, Lunch · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A melty egg and cheese tucked between toasted bread, easy to wrap and take along.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 eggs
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- 2 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Fry eggs in butter, breaking the yolks.
2. Top each with cheese until it melts.
3. Serve between toasted bread. Wrap in foil to take along.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 340 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 374 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 255 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 170 cal

Per adult serving: 340 cal · 18 g protein · 29 g carbs · 17 g fat · 4 g fiber · 483 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.20 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.70 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

French toast

Breakfast, Dinner · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Thick slices soaked in vanilla-cinnamon custard and griddled until crisp and golden.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 eggs
- 1 cup milk
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 12 slices white bread
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ¾ cup pancake syrup

Steps

1. Whisk eggs, milk, cinnamon and vanilla in a shallow dish.
2. Dip bread about 5 seconds per side.
3. Cook on a buttered griddle over medium heat, 2–3 minutes per side.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 577 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 634 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 432 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 288 cal

Per adult serving: 577 cal · 19 g protein · 86 g carbs · 17 g fat · 2 g fiber · 651 mg sodium · 36 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.10 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.89 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Gluten-free banana muffins

Breakfast, Snack, Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Soft, sweet banana muffins with a cinnamon whisper, baked gluten-free.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups gluten-free flour blend *
- ½ cup sugar
- 1 tsp baking soda
- ½ tsp salt
- 3 bananas, mashed
- 1 egg
- 5 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp vanilla
- ½ tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Mix the gluten-free flour, sugar, baking soda, salt and cinnamon.
2. Stir in banana, egg, oil and vanilla.
3. Fill 12 greased muffin cups; bake at 350°F for 22 minutes. Serving = 2 muffins.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 378 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 416 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 284 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 189 cal

Per adult serving: 378 cal · 4 g protein · 62 g carbs · 13 g fat · 3 g fiber · 414 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.03 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.66 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Gluten-free cinnamon-raisin oatmeal

Breakfast · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Cozy cinnamon oats studded with raisins and a touch of brown sugar, made with certified gluten-free oats.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups certified gluten-free oats *
- 2 cups milk, plus 2 cups water
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- ¼ cup raisins
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Bring the milk, water and salt to a boil.
2. Stir in the gluten-free oats; simmer 5 minutes.
3. Stir in cinnamon, brown sugar and raisins.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 295 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 325 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 221 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 148 cal

Per adult serving: 295 cal · 9 g protein · 55 g carbs · 5 g fat · 5 g fiber · 137 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.45 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.53 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Gluten-free pancakes

Breakfast, Dinner · Gluten-free · Vegetarian

Golden, tender gluten-free pancakes that taste just like the classic diner stack.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups gluten-free flour blend *
- 2 Tbsp sugar
- 4 tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp salt
- 2 eggs
- 1¾ cups milk
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¾ cup pancake syrup

Steps

1. Whisk the gluten-free flour, sugar, baking powder and salt.
2. Whisk in eggs, milk and 2 Tbsp oil; rest 5 minutes.
3. Cook ¼ cup at a time on a lightly oiled griddle.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 583 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 641 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 437 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 292 cal

Per adult serving: 583 cal · 10 g protein · 100 g carbs · 16 g fat · 2 g fiber · 915 mg sodium · 36 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.79 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.04 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham and cheese omelets with toast

Breakfast, Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Fluffy omelets stuffed with ham, peppers and melted cheddar, with buttered toast.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 eggs
- ¼ lb sliced ham, diced
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- ½ bell pepper, diced
- 4 Tbsp butter
- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. For each omelet, beat 2 eggs with a pinch of salt; pour into a buttered skillet over medium heat.
2. When nearly set, add ham, pepper and cheese to one half; fold and cook 1 minute.
3. Serve with buttered toast.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 497 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 546 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 372 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 248 cal

Per adult serving: 497 cal · 29 g protein · 31 g carbs · 29 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,042 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.67 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.45 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham, egg and cheese breakfast buns

Breakfast, Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Fluffy scrambled eggs, ham and cheese tucked into soft toasted buns.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 eggs
- ¼ lb sliced ham, diced
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- 2 Tbsp butter
- 4 hamburger buns

Steps

1. Scramble eggs and ham in butter.
2. Toast buns; fill with egg and cheese. Wrap in foil to take along.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 386 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 424 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 289 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 193 cal

Per adult serving: 386 cal · 23 g protein · 28 g carbs · 20 g fat · 1 g fiber · 758 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.94 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.07 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham, egg and cheese breakfast quesadillas

Breakfast, Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy tortillas filled with scrambled eggs, ham and gooey melted cheddar.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 flour tortillas
- 6 eggs
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ¼ lb sliced ham, chopped
- ½ cup salsa
- 1 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Scramble the eggs in butter with the ham.
2. Fill 4 tortillas with egg and cheese; top with the other 4.
3. Cook in a dry skillet 2 minutes per side; cut in wedges. Serve with salsa.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 566 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 623 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 425 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 283 cal

Per adult serving: 566 cal · 29 g protein · 51 g carbs · 27 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,528 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.97 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.52 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Honey nut o's with bananas

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Crunchy honey nut o's with cold milk and fresh banana slices.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 cups honey nut o's
- 4 cups milk
- 2 bananas, sliced

Steps

1. Pour cereal into bowls; add milk and banana slices.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 385 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 423 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 288 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 192 cal

Per adult serving: 385 cal · 13 g protein · 71 g carbs · 8 g fat · 6 g fiber · 401 mg sodium · 15 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.68 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.58 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hot cocoa oatmeal

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Chocolatey hot cocoa oatmeal topped with fresh banana.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2 cups milk
- 2 servings hot cocoa mix
- 2 bananas

Steps

1. Cook oats in milk and 2 cups water 5 minutes.
2. Stir in hot cocoa mix; top with banana.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 319 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 350 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 239 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 159 cal

Per adult serving: 319 cal · 10 g protein · 58 g carbs · 6 g fat · 6 g fiber · 136 mg sodium · 9 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.20 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.48 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Huevos rancheros

Breakfast, Dinner · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Crisp corn tortillas layered with refried beans, fried eggs, warm salsa and cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 corn tortillas
- 8 eggs
- 1 cup dehydrated refried bean flakes
- 1 cup salsa
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Make refried beans: stir flakes into 1¼ cups boiling water; cover 5 minutes.
2. Crisp tortillas in a little oil; fry eggs in the rest.
3. Layer tortillas, beans, eggs, warm salsa and cheese.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 498 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 548 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 374 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 249 cal

Per adult serving: 498 cal · 26 g protein · 45 g carbs · 24 g fat · 10 g fiber · 1,191 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.53 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.20 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Orange and yogurt cups

Snack, Breakfast · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy orange segments layered with creamy vanilla yogurt.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 oranges
- 2 cups vanilla yogurt

Steps

1. Segment oranges; layer with yogurt.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 152 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 167 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 114 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 76 cal

Per adult serving: 152 cal · 6 g protein · 28 g carbs · 2 g fat · 2 g fiber · 75 mg sodium · 8 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.69 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.02 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pancakes with sausage

Breakfast, Dinner

Stacks of golden pancakes with sizzling sausage patties and plenty of syrup.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cups pancake mix
- ½ lb pork sausage
- ¾ cup pancake syrup
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 oranges

Steps

1. Shape sausage into 8 thin patties; brown 4 minutes per side.
2. Mix pancake batter with water per the box until just combined.
3. Pour ¼ cup batter onto a hot oiled griddle; flip when bubbles form.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 741 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 815 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 556 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 371 cal

Per adult serving: 741 cal · 17 g protein · 119 g carbs · 22 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,528 mg sodium · 36 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.81 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.26 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pantry pancakes (dry milk)

Breakfast, Dinner · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Fluffy from-scratch pancakes made with pantry dry milk.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 1½ cups non-fat dry milk (mixed), powder for 1½ cups
- 2 Tbsp sugar
- 4 tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp salt
- 1 egg
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¾ cup pancake syrup

Steps

1. Whisk flour, dry milk powder, sugar, baking powder and salt.
2. Add egg, 2 Tbsp oil and 1½ cups water; stir just to combine.
3. Cook ¼ cup at a time on an oiled griddle.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 549 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 604 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 412 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 275 cal

Per adult serving: 549 cal · 11 g protein · 99 g carbs · 12 g fat · 2 g fiber · 896 mg sodium · 36 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.32 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.50 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

PB&J overnight oats

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy peanut butter overnight oats topped with a swirl of raspberry jam.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2 cups milk
- 4 Tbsp peanut butter
- 4 Tbsp raspberry jam

Steps

1. Stir oats and milk with peanut butter; top each jar with jam.
2. Refrigerate overnight.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 356 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 392 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 267 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 178 cal

Per adult serving: 356 cal · 13 g protein · 49 g carbs · 13 g fat · 5 g fiber · 135 mg sodium · 11 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.00 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.43 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Peanut butter-banana oatmeal

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Rich, nutty oatmeal swirled with melty peanut butter and topped with sweet banana and honey.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2 cups milk, plus 2 cups water
- 4 Tbsp peanut butter
- 2 bananas, sliced
- 2 Tbsp honey
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Bring the milk, water and salt to a boil; stir in oats and simmer 5 minutes.
2. Stir in the peanut butter until melted.
3. Top with banana slices and a drizzle of honey.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 391 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 430 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 293 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 195 cal

Per adult serving: 391 cal · 14 g protein · 58 g carbs · 13 g fat · 7 g fiber · 203 mg sodium · 10 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.79 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.61 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Peanut butter-banana toast

Breakfast, Snack · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Warm toast spread with peanut butter, topped with banana and a drizzle of honey.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- 8 Tbsp peanut butter
- 2 bananas, sliced
- 2 Tbsp honey

Steps

1. Toast the bread; spread with peanut butter.
2. Top with banana slices and a drizzle of honey.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 435 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 478 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 326 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 217 cal

Per adult serving: 435 cal · 17 g protein · 56 g carbs · 18 g fat · 8 g fiber · 421 mg sodium · 15 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.96 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.64 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Potato, pepper and egg hash

Breakfast, Dinner · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy skillet potatoes with peppers and onions, topped with soft-set eggs and cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 potatoes, diced small
- 1 onion, diced
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 8 eggs
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook potatoes in oil over medium heat, covered, 10 minutes, stirring often.
2. Add onion and pepper; cook uncovered until browned, about 8 minutes. Season.
3. Make 8 wells, crack in the eggs, cover and cook 5 minutes. Top with cheese.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 440 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 484 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 330 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 220 cal

Per adult serving: 440 cal · 21 g protein · 42 g carbs · 22 g fat · 5 g fiber · 530 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.87 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.49 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Raisin bran and fruit

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty raisin bran with cold milk and juicy orange wedges on the side.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cups raisin bran
- 4 cups milk
- 2 oranges

Steps

1. Serve cereal with milk and orange wedges on the side.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 343 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 377 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 257 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 172 cal

Per adult serving: 343 cal · 14 g protein · 66 g carbs · 6 g fat · 9 g fiber · 325 mg sodium · 9 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.97 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.86 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Raisin bran muffins

Breakfast, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Moist, hearty raisin bran muffins, great for breakfast on the go.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cups raisin bran
- 1¼ cups milk
- 1¼ cups flour
- ½ cup sugar
- 1¼ tsp baking soda
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1 egg
- 4 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Soak cereal in milk 5 minutes.
2. Stir in egg and oil, then flour, sugar, baking soda and salt.
3. Fill 12 muffin cups; bake at 400°F for 18 minutes. Serving = 2 muffins.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 372 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 409 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 279 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 186 cal

Per adult serving: 372 cal · 8 g protein · 62 g carbs · 12 g fat · 4 g fiber · 500 mg sodium · 21 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.64 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.36 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Raspberry jam toast with eggs

Breakfast · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Buttery toast with sweet raspberry jam and eggs your way.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 slices white bread
- 2 Tbsp butter
- 4 Tbsp raspberry jam
- 4 eggs

Steps

1. Fry or scramble eggs.
2. Toast bread; spread with butter and raspberry jam.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 323 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 355 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 242 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 162 cal

Per adult serving: 323 cal · 11 g protein · 41 g carbs · 13 g fat · 1 g fiber · 400 mg sodium · 14 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.42 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.53 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Roast beef hash with eggs

Breakfast, Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy potatoes and roast beef topped with fried eggs, made from leftover roast.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb beef roast, cooked, diced
- 4 potatoes, diced
- 1 onion
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 4 eggs
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook potatoes and onion in oil, covered, 10 minutes; uncover and brown.
2. Add cooked beef; cook until crisp; season.
3. Top each serving with a fried egg. Uses leftover pot roast.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 558 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 614 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 419 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 279 cal

Per adult serving: 558 cal · 32 g protein · 40 g carbs · 31 g fat · 5 g fiber · 439 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $13.43 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.92 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sausage and egg breakfast casserole

Breakfast, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Savory sausage, eggs and melted cheese baked into a golden, sliceable casserole.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb pork sausage
- 6 slices white bread, cubed
- 8 eggs
- 2 cups milk
- 1½ cups shredded cheddar
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Brown sausage; drain. Spread bread cubes in a greased 9x13 pan; top with sausage and cheese.
2. Whisk eggs, milk, salt and pepper; pour over. Refrigerate overnight if you like.
3. Bake at 350°F for 45 minutes, until set in the center.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 407 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 447 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 305 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 203 cal

Per adult serving: 407 cal · 23 g protein · 14 g carbs · 28 g fat · 1 g fiber · 829 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.28 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.15 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sausage hash brown skillet with toast

Breakfast, Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy hash browns, sausage and eggs under melted cheese, with toast.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ¾ lb pork sausage
- 4 potatoes, shredded or diced
- ½ onion
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 4 eggs
- ¾ cup shredded cheddar
- 4 slices whole wheat bread
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Brown sausage; remove. Cook potatoes and onion in oil until crisp, about 15 minutes; salt.
2. Stir sausage back in; make 4 wells and crack in eggs; cover 5 minutes.
3. Top with cheese; serve with buttered toast.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 758 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 833 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 568 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 379 cal

Per adult serving: 758 cal · 31 g protein · 53 g carbs · 47 g fat · 6 g fiber · 1,212 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.31 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.02 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sausage pancake bake

Breakfast, Dinner · Packs to go

Fluffy pancake batter baked over savory sausage and cheese, served with syrup.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups pancake mix
- 1½ cups milk
- 2 eggs
- 1 lb pork sausage
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup pancake syrup
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Brown sausage; drain; spread in a greased 9x13 pan.
2. Whisk pancake mix, milk, eggs and oil; pour over sausage; sprinkle cheese.
3. Bake at 350°F for 25 minutes. Cut in squares; serve with syrup.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 559 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 615 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 419 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 280 cal

Per adult serving: 559 cal · 20 g protein · 53 g carbs · 29 g fat · 1 g fiber · 1,100 mg sodium · 16 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.39 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.17 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sausage, egg and cheese biscuit sandwiches

Breakfast, Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Flaky homemade biscuits stacked with sausage, egg and melted cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 6 Tbsp butter, cold
- ¾ cup milk
- 1 lb pork sausage
- 6 eggs
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Make biscuits: mix flour, baking powder and salt; cut in butter; stir in milk; cut 8 rounds; bake at 450°F for 10–12 minutes.
2. Shape sausage into 8 patties; brown 4 minutes per side.
3. Scramble eggs; split biscuits and fill with sausage, egg and cheese. Wrap in foil to take along.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 895 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 984 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 671 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 447 cal

Per adult serving: 895 cal · 36 g protein · 51 g carbs · 59 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,993 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.99 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.95 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Scrambled eggs and toast

Breakfast, Dinner · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Soft, buttery scrambled eggs with warm toast, jam and bright orange wedges.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 eggs
- ¼ cup milk
- 3 Tbsp butter
- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- 4 Tbsp strawberry jam
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper
- 2 oranges, cut in wedges

Steps

1. Whisk eggs, milk, salt and pepper.
2. Cook in 1 Tbsp butter over medium-low heat, stirring gently, until just set.
3. Toast the bread; spread with butter and jam. Serve with oranges.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 469 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 516 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 352 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 235 cal

Per adult serving: 469 cal · 22 g protein · 50 g carbs · 21 g fat · 6 g fiber · 643 mg sodium · 14 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.35 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.16 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Skillet hash browns

Side dish, Breakfast · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy, golden skillet hash browns.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 potatoes, shredded
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Squeeze shredded potato dry.
2. Cook in hot oil, pressed flat, 6 minutes per side until crisp. Season.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 250 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 275 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 188 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 125 cal

Per adult serving: 250 cal · 4 g protein · 37 g carbs · 11 g fat · 4 g fiber · 301 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.29 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.50 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tofu scramble tacos

Breakfast, Dinner, Lunch · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Savory, golden tofu scramble with peppers and onions, tucked into warm corn tortillas.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 block firm tofu, pressed dry *
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ onion, diced
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- ½ tsp garlic powder *
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper
- 8 corn tortillas
- ½ cup salsa

Steps

1. Cook onion and pepper in oil 5 minutes.
2. Crumble in tofu; add garlic powder, salt and pepper; cook 5 minutes, stirring.
3. Warm tortillas in a dry skillet; fill with scramble and salsa.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 251 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 276 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 188 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 125 cal

Per adult serving: 251 cal · 13 g protein · 29 g carbs · 11 g fat · 5 g fiber · 544 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.71 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.24 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Vegan overnight oats

Breakfast · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Cool, creamy oats that soak overnight with apple and cinnamon, ready to grab on a busy morning.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2½ cups soy or oat milk *
- 1 apple, grated
- ¼ cup raisins
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup pancake syrup

Steps

1. Stir everything together in a bowl or 4 jars.
2. Cover and refrigerate overnight.
3. Eat cold or warm 1 minute. Packs well for work or school.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 308 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 339 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 231 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 154 cal

Per adult serving: 308 cal · 10 g protein · 58 g carbs · 5 g fat · 6 g fiber · 78 mg sodium · 10 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.25 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.71 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Vegan pancakes from scratch

Breakfast, Dinner · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick

Light, fluffy pancakes made from scratch with banana, no eggs or milk needed.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 2 Tbsp sugar
- 4 tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp salt
- 1¾ cups soy or oat milk *
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 banana, mashed
- ¾ cup pancake syrup

Steps

1. Whisk flour, sugar, baking powder and salt.
2. Stir in plant milk, 2 Tbsp oil and banana until just combined.
3. Cook ¼ cup at a time on a lightly oiled griddle.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 562 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 619 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 422 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 281 cal

Per adult serving: 562 cal · 10 g protein · 103 g carbs · 13 g fat · 3 g fiber · 871 mg sodium · 36 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.68 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.58 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Yogurt and raisin bran crunch cups

Snack, Breakfast · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Creamy yogurt topped with crunchy raisin bran and a drizzle of honey.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups vanilla yogurt
- 1 cup raisin bran
- 1 Tbsp honey

Steps

1. Spoon yogurt into cups; top with cereal and a drizzle of honey just before eating.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 169 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 185 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 126 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 84 cal

Per adult serving: 169 cal · 6 g protein · 33 g carbs · 2 g fat · 2 g fiber · 128 mg sodium · 14 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.29 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.71 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Yogurt parfaits with honey-toasted oats

Breakfast, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Layers of smooth vanilla yogurt, ripe banana and crunchy honey-toasted oats.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups rolled oats
- 2 Tbsp honey
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp cinnamon
- 4 cups vanilla yogurt
- 2 bananas, sliced

Steps

1. Toss oats with honey, oil and cinnamon; spread on a baking sheet.
2. Bake at 325°F for 15 minutes, stirring once; cool.
3. Layer yogurt, banana and toasted oats in bowls or jars.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 438 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 482 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 328 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 219 cal

Per adult serving: 438 cal · 14 g protein · 77 g carbs · 9 g fat · 5 g fiber · 153 mg sodium · 24 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.07 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.54 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Lunches

Barbecue shredded beef sandwiches

Dinner, Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go

Slow-roasted beef shredded into a sweet, smoky barbecue sauce on soft buns.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3¾ lb beef roast
- 14 Tbsp ketchup
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 3 Tbsp white vinegar *
- 2 Tbsp mustard
- 1 onion
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 1 tsp salt
- 8 hamburger buns

Steps

1. Season roast; set on sliced onion with 1 cup water; cover; bake at 300°F for 4 hours.
2. Shred beef; simmer ketchup, brown sugar, vinegar, mustard and garlic 10 minutes; toss with the beef.
3. Pile onto buns.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 659 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 725 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 494 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 330 cal

Per adult serving: 659 cal · 45 g protein · 50 g carbs · 30 g fat · 1 g fiber · 961 mg sodium · 23 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $20.09 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $4.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Bean and cheese burritos

Lunch, Dinner · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy refried beans, melted cheddar and salsa wrapped in soft flour tortillas.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups dehydrated refried bean flakes
- 8 flour tortillas
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- ½ cup salsa

Steps

1. Stir bean flakes into 2½ cups boiling water; cover 5 minutes.
2. Spread beans on tortillas; add cheese and salsa; roll.
3. Wrap in foil. Eat at room temperature or reheat 1 minute.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 736 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 810 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 552 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 368 cal

Per adult serving: 736 cal · 34 g protein · 89 g carbs · 28 g fat · 15 g fiber · 1,975 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.49 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.63 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef and bean burritos

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Seasoned beef, creamy refried beans and cheese wrapped in soft tortillas.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1 cup dehydrated refried bean flakes
- 8 flour tortillas
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ cup sour cream

Steps

1. Brown beef; drain; add taco seasoning and ½ cup water.
2. Make refried beans with 1¼ cups boiling water.
3. Fill tortillas with beans, beef and cheese; roll; wrap in foil. Serve with salsa and sour cream.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 862 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 948 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 646 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 431 cal

Per adult serving: 862 cal · 42 g protein · 72 g carbs · 45 g fat · 9 g fiber · 1,715 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $13.31 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.89 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef roast vegetable soup

Lunch, Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty chunks of beef and garden vegetables in a rich tomato broth.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb beef roast, cubed
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 3 potatoes
- 3 carrots
- 1 onion
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 1 can corn
- 1 can green beans
- 4 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *

Steps

1. Brown beef cubes in oil.
2. Add onion, tomatoes, bouillon, seasoning and 8 cups water; simmer 1½ hours.
3. Add potatoes and carrots for 25 minutes, then corn and green beans for 5.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 321 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 353 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 241 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 160 cal

Per adult serving: 321 cal · 20 g protein · 30 g carbs · 14 g fat · 5 g fiber · 947 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.53 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.29 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef stew thermos with bread

Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty, steaming beef stew packed hot, with buttered bread for dipping.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans canned beef stew
- 4 slices whole wheat bread
- 2 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Heat stew until steaming; pack in preheated thermoses.
2. Pack buttered bread.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 511 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 562 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 383 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 256 cal

Per adult serving: 511 cal · 22 g protein · 46 g carbs · 27 g fat · 8 g fiber · 2,085 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.92 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef stew with buttered bread

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty, ready-to-heat beef stew with soft buttered bread.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans canned beef stew
- 4 slices white bread
- 2 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Heat stew until steaming (thermos: preheat with boiling water first).
2. Serve with buttered bread.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 506 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 557 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 380 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 253 cal

Per adult serving: 506 cal · 21 g protein · 46 g carbs · 27 g fat · 7 g fiber · 2,085 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.74 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.33 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Black bean and corn burrito bowls

Lunch, Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Zesty black beans and sweet corn over rice with fresh tomato, lettuce and salsa.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cans black beans, drained
- 1 can corn, drained
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1 cup salsa
- 1 tomato, diced
- ½ head lettuce, shredded

Steps

1. Cook rice as on the package.
2. Warm beans and corn with taco seasoning and ¼ cup water.
3. Divide into containers; top with tomato, lettuce and salsa.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 541 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 595 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 405 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 270 cal

Per adult serving: 541 cal · 20 g protein · 111 g carbs · 2 g fat · 18 g fiber · 1,512 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.77 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.47 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Black bean and corn salad

Lunch, Dinner, Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A bright, zesty salad of black beans, sweet corn, peppers and tomatoes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans black beans, drained
- 2 cans corn, drained
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- ¼ onion, diced
- 2 tomatoes, diced
- ½ cup salsa
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1½ tsp taco seasoning *
- 8 corn tortillas, warmed

Steps

1. Stir everything except tortillas together.
2. Chill 30 minutes. Eat with warm tortillas or crisped tortilla chips.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 501 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 551 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 375 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 250 cal

Per adult serving: 501 cal · 20 g protein · 87 g carbs · 11 g fat · 22 g fiber · 1,387 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.46 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.84 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Black bean quesadillas

Lunch, Dinner · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy tortillas filled with black beans and gooey cheese, served with salsa and sour cream.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 flour tortillas
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 1 can black beans, drained
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ cup sour cream

Steps

1. Fill 4 tortillas with cheese and beans; top with the other 4.
2. Cook in a dry skillet 2–3 minutes per side.
3. Cut in wedges; serve with salsa and sour cream.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 668 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 735 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 501 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 334 cal

Per adult serving: 668 cal · 29 g protein · 69 g carbs · 32 g fat · 9 g fiber · 1,640 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.05 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.53 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Bun-wrapped corn-style dogs

Lunch, Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Cheese-stuffed franks baked in soft buns, a fun corn dog stand-in.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 beef franks
- 8 hot dog buns
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- 2 Tbsp mustard
- 2 Tbsp ketchup

Steps

1. Split franks lengthwise; stuff with cheese.
2. Bake in buns at 375°F for 10 minutes. Serve with mustard and ketchup.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 712 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 783 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 534 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 356 cal

Per adult serving: 712 cal · 26 g protein · 59 g carbs · 41 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,693 mg sodium · 8 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.93 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.51 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cheesy potato soup

Dinner, Lunch · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Thick, creamy potato soup finished with melted cheddar and sour cream.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 potatoes, diced
- 1 onion
- 4 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup flour
- 4 cups milk
- 2 cubes vegetable bouillon *
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup sour cream
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook onion in butter 5 minutes; stir in flour.
2. Add potatoes, bouillon and 3 cups water; simmer 15 minutes.
3. Add milk; heat without boiling; stir in cheese and sour cream.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 452 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 498 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 339 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 226 cal

Per adult serving: 452 cal · 16 g protein · 53 g carbs · 21 g fat · 5 g fiber · 577 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.17 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.12 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken and rice soup

Dinner, Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A soothing, homestyle soup of chicken, rice and tender carrots.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb chicken breasts
- 1 cup rice (uncooked)
- 3 carrots, sliced
- 1 onion, diced
- 4 cubes chicken bouillon *
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer chicken, onion, carrots and bouillon in 8 cups water 20 minutes.
2. Remove chicken, shred and return; add rice and simmer 18 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 232 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 255 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 174 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 116 cal

Per adult serving: 232 cal · 20 g protein · 30 g carbs · 2 g fat · 2 g fiber · 865 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.28 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.93 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken burrito bowls

Lunch, Dinner · Gluten-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Seasoned chicken and black beans over rice with salsa, cheese and crisp lettuce.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cans black beans, drained
- 2 cans canned chicken breast pieces, drained
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1 cup salsa
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ¼ head lettuce, shredded

Steps

1. Cook rice as on the package.
2. Heat beans and chicken with taco seasoning and ¼ cup water.
3. Divide rice, beans and chicken into containers; top with salsa, cheese and lettuce.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 792 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 871 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 594 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 396 cal

Per adult serving: 792 cal · 60 g protein · 97 g carbs · 16 g fat · 15 g fiber · 2,207 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $14.02 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.05 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken noodle soup

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Classic, comforting chicken noodle soup with tender carrots.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb chicken breasts
- 8 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- 3 carrots, sliced
- 1 onion, diced
- 4 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook onion and carrots in butter 5 minutes.
2. Add chicken, bouillon and 8 cups water; simmer 20 minutes; shred chicken.
3. Add noodles; simmer 8 minutes. Season.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 299 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 328 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 224 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 149 cal

Per adult serving: 299 cal · 23 g protein · 32 g carbs · 8 g fat · 3 g fiber · 900 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.07 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.10 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken ranch wraps

Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender chicken tossed in creamy ranch with cheese and crisp veggies in a wrap.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb chicken breasts
- 6 Tbsp ranch dressing
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ head lettuce, shredded
- 1 tomato, diced
- 6 flour tortillas
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer or bake chicken to 165°F; cool and dice.
2. Toss chicken with ranch; fill tortillas with chicken, cheese, lettuce and tomato; roll tightly.
3. Pack with an ice pack.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 580 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 638 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 435 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 290 cal

Per adult serving: 580 cal · 39 g protein · 41 g carbs · 28 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,122 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.08 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.19 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken rotini soup

Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Warm, comforting chicken rotini soup, ready in minutes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans chicken rotini soup

Steps

1. Heat soup until steaming; pack in a preheated thermos for lunch.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 200 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 220 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 150 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 100 cal

Per adult serving: 200 cal · 8 g protein · 28 g carbs · 6 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,800 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.89 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.28 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken rotini soup with PB-honey sandwich

Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go

Warm chicken rotini soup in a thermos with a sweet peanut butter and honey sandwich.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans chicken rotini soup
- 4 slices whole wheat bread
- 4 Tbsp peanut butter
- 2 Tbsp honey

Steps

1. Heat soup; pack in thermoses preheated with boiling water.
2. Make 2 peanut butter-honey sandwiches and cut in half.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 407 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 448 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 305 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 204 cal

Per adult serving: 407 cal · 16 g protein · 54 g carbs · 15 g fat · 5 g fiber · 2,011 mg sodium · 12 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.36 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.60 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken salad wraps

Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Cool, creamy chicken salad with crunchy cucumber, rolled tight in soft tortillas.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans canned chicken breast pieces, drained
- 8 Tbsp mayo
- ½ cucumber, diced
- ¼ head lettuce
- 8 flour tortillas
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Mix chicken, mayo, cucumber and pepper.
2. Spread on tortillas, add lettuce and roll tightly. Pack with an ice pack.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 771 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 848 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 578 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 385 cal

Per adult serving: 771 cal · 61 g protein · 50 g carbs · 36 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,934 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $15.77 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.43 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken tortilla soup

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A zesty chicken soup with beans and corn, topped with crispy tortilla strips.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned chicken breast pieces
- 1 can black beans
- 1 can corn
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- ½ cup salsa
- 3 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 8 corn tortillas
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Simmer chicken, beans, corn, tomatoes, salsa, bouillon, seasoning and 4 cups water 20 minutes.
2. Cut tortillas into strips; toss with oil; bake at 400°F for 8 minutes.
3. Top bowls with tortilla strips and cheese.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 408 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 449 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 306 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 204 cal

Per adult serving: 408 cal · 35 g protein · 42 g carbs · 12 g fat · 10 g fiber · 1,888 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.40 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.04 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chickpea salad sandwiches

Lunch · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A creamy, crunchy chickpea salad sandwich with cucumber and a tangy mustard kick.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans chickpeas, drained *
- 6 Tbsp mayo
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- ½ cucumber, diced
- ¼ onion, diced
- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- ¼ head lettuce
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Mash chickpeas with a fork; stir in mayo, mustard, cucumber, onion and salt.
2. Pack filling cold; build sandwiches at lunch.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 486 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 534 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 364 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 243 cal

Per adult serving: 486 cal · 18 g protein · 59 g carbs · 20 g fat · 13 g fiber · 1,056 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.92 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.07 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chili and rice thermos

Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty chili spooned over rice and topped with cheddar, packed hot to go.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans canned chili
- 1 cup rice (uncooked)
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Cook rice. Heat chili.
2. Pack chili over rice in preheated thermoses; top with cheese.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 618 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 680 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 464 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 309 cal

Per adult serving: 618 cal · 29 g protein · 72 g carbs · 23 g fat · 11 g fiber · 1,515 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.45 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.40 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chili bowls with cheese and onion

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Steaming bowls of chili topped with cheese, onion and sour cream.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans canned chili
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- ¼ onion, diced
- ¼ cup sour cream

Steps

1. Heat chili until steaming.
2. Top with cheese, onion and sour cream.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 607 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 668 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 456 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 304 cal

Per adult serving: 607 cal · 34 g protein · 47 g carbs · 31 g fat · 14 g fiber · 1,995 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.02 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.74 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chili dogs

Lunch, Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy franks piled with hearty chili, melted cheese and chopped onion.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 beef franks
- 8 hot dog buns
- 2 cans canned chili
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- ¼ onion, diced

Steps

1. Simmer franks 5 minutes; heat chili.
2. Top franks in buns with chili, cheese and onion.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 960 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,056 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 720 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 480 cal

Per adult serving: 960 cal · 41 g protein · 80 g carbs · 53 g fat · 9 g fiber · 2,478 mg sodium · 9 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.23 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.22 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chili over rice

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty chili over fluffy rice with melted cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans canned chili
- 1 cup rice (uncooked)
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Cook rice; heat chili.
2. Spoon chili over rice; top with cheese.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 618 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 680 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 464 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 309 cal

Per adult serving: 618 cal · 29 g protein · 72 g carbs · 23 g fat · 11 g fiber · 1,515 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.45 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.40 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chili tortilla chip pie

Lunch, Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Crunchy baked tortilla chips piled with hot chili, cheese, lettuce and onion.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans canned chili
- 12 corn tortillas
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¼ tsp salt
- ¾ cup shredded cheddar
- ¼ head lettuce
- ¼ onion

Steps

1. Bake tortilla chips: brush tortillas with oil, cut in wedges, salt, bake at 375°F for 10 minutes.
2. Heat chili; spoon over chips; top with cheese, lettuce and onion.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 678 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 746 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 508 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 339 cal

Per adult serving: 678 cal · 33 g protein · 69 g carbs · 32 g fat · 16 g fiber · 1,734 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.18 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.78 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chili-topped baked potatoes

Lunch, Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Fluffy baked potatoes smothered in chili and cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned chili
- 4 potatoes
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Bake or microwave potatoes until tender.
2. Split and top with hot chili and cheese.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 477 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 525 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 358 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 238 cal

Per adult serving: 477 cal · 23 g protein · 60 g carbs · 17 g fat · 11 g fiber · 1,051 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.25 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.36 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Classic macaroni salad

Side dish, Lunch · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy, tangy classic macaroni salad with crunchy vegetables.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 oz macaroni
- 8 Tbsp mayo
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- 3 tsp sugar
- ¼ onion, minced
- ½ bell pepper, diced
- 1 carrot, grated
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook macaroni; rinse cold; drain well.
2. Stir in mayo, mustard, sugar, vegetables and salt; chill 1 hour.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 271 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 298 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 203 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 136 cal

Per adult serving: 271 cal · 5 g protein · 32 g carbs · 14 g fat · 2 g fiber · 348 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.84 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.40 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cream of mushroom soup with toast

Lunch · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Velvety cream of mushroom soup with warm buttered toast.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans cream of mushroom soup
- 2 cups milk
- 4 slices white bread
- 1 Tbsp butter
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Whisk soup with milk and 1 can water; heat; season with pepper.
2. Serve with buttered toast.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 349 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 384 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 262 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 175 cal

Per adult serving: 349 cal · 10 g protein · 37 g carbs · 18 g fat · 1 g fiber · 1,795 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.18 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.13 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Creamy chicken soup with toast

Lunch · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy chicken soup with tender chicken and buttered toast.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans cream of chicken soup
- 1 can canned chicken breast pieces
- 2 cups milk
- 4 slices whole wheat bread
- 1 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Whisk soup with milk and 1 can water; add drained chicken; heat through.
2. Serve with buttered toast.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 492 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 541 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 369 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 246 cal

Per adult serving: 492 cal · 32 g protein · 41 g carbs · 23 g fat · 3 g fiber · 2,220 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.35 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.03 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Creamy sausage and potato soup

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A creamy, hearty soup of savory sausage and tender potatoes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb pork sausage
- 4 potatoes, diced
- 1 onion
- 3 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 2 Tbsp butter
- 3 Tbsp flour
- 2 cups milk
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Brown sausage with onion; drain; add butter and stir in flour.
2. Add potatoes, bouillon and 5 cups water; simmer 15 minutes.
3. Stir in milk; heat through.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 425 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 468 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 319 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 213 cal

Per adult serving: 425 cal · 16 g protein · 34 g carbs · 25 g fat · 3 g fiber · 995 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.86 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.27 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Creamy tomato soup with cheese toast

Lunch · Vegetarian

Creamy tomato soup with crunchy, cheesy toast strips for dipping.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans tomato soup
- 3 cups milk
- 4 slices white bread
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 2 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Heat soup with milk, stirring.
2. Butter bread; top with cheese; broil 2 minutes until bubbly. Cut into strips for dipping.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 496 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 546 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 372 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 248 cal

Per adult serving: 496 cal · 19 g protein · 61 g carbs · 20 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,346 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.51 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.63 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free chicken burrito bowls

Lunch, Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Seasoned chicken, black beans and corn over rice with salsa and lettuce.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cans black beans, drained
- 2 cans canned chicken breast pieces, drained
- 1 can corn, drained
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1 cup salsa
- ¼ head lettuce, shredded

Steps

1. Cook rice.
2. Heat beans, chicken and corn with taco seasoning and ¼ cup water.
3. Divide into containers; top with salsa and lettuce.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 730 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 803 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 548 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 365 cal

Per adult serving: 730 cal · 55 g protein · 108 g carbs · 8 g fat · 17 g fiber · 2,207 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $13.34 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.90 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free creamy potato soup

Lunch, Dinner · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A thick, velvety potato soup made creamy with plant milk.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 potatoes, diced
- 1 onion
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¼ cup flour
- 3 cups soy or oat milk *
- 2 cubes vegetable bouillon *
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook onion in oil 5 minutes; stir in flour.
2. Add potatoes, bouillon and 3 cups water; simmer 15 minutes.
3. Add plant milk; mash some potatoes to thicken; heat through.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 290 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 319 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 218 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 145 cal

Per adult serving: 290 cal · 9 g protein · 45 g carbs · 9 g fat · 5 g fiber · 551 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.70 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.80 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Egg salad on gluten-free bread

Lunch · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Rich, creamy egg salad served on gluten-free bread.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 eggs
- 6 Tbsp mayo
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- 8 slices gluten-free bread *
- ¼ head lettuce
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Hard-boil eggs 11 minutes; cool and peel.
2. Chop; mix with mayo, mustard, salt and pepper.
3. Pack cold; build sandwiches on gluten-free bread at lunch.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 466 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 513 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 350 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 233 cal

Per adult serving: 466 cal · 17 g protein · 34 g carbs · 29 g fat · 3 g fiber · 765 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.59 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.43 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Egg salad sandwiches

Lunch · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy, classic egg salad with a touch of mustard on soft wheat bread.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 eggs
- 6 Tbsp mayo
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- ¼ head lettuce
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Hard-boil eggs 11 minutes; cool in cold water and peel.
2. Chop; mix with mayo, mustard, salt and pepper.
3. Pack filling cold with an ice pack; build sandwiches at lunch.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 446 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 491 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 335 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 223 cal

Per adult serving: 446 cal · 21 g protein · 30 g carbs · 27 g fat · 5 g fiber · 745 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.29 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.93 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Franks and beans

Lunch, Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go

Sweet, saucy pork and beans simmered with sliced franks.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans pork and beans
- 6 beef franks, sliced
- 2 Tbsp ketchup

Steps

1. Heat pork and beans with sliced franks and ketchup 10 minutes.
2. Pack hot in a thermos for lunch.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 648 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 712 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 486 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 324 cal

Per adult serving: 648 cal · 25 g protein · 79 g carbs · 27 g fat · 16 g fiber · 2,090 mg sodium · 25 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.47 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.41 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

French dip sandwiches

Dinner, Lunch · Lower-sugar pick

Thin-sliced roast beef and melted cheese on toasted rolls with savory broth for dipping.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3¾ lb beef roast
- 4 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 2 onions, sliced
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1 tsp salt
- 8 hot dog buns
- 1 cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Season roast; set on onions with bouillon and 4 cups water; cover; bake at 300°F for 3½ hours.
2. Slice or shred beef; strain the broth for dipping.
3. Fill buns with beef and cheese; broil 2 minutes. Serve with cups of broth.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 637 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 700 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 478 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 318 cal

Per adult serving: 637 cal · 49 g protein · 30 g carbs · 35 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,173 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $20.67 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $4.49 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Gluten-free pasta salad

Lunch, Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A cool, crunchy pasta salad with olives, cheddar and ranch, made with gluten-free pasta.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 oz gluten-free pasta *
- 1 cucumber, diced
- 2 tomatoes, diced
- 1 can black olives, sliced
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 6 Tbsp ranch dressing
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook gluten-free pasta; rinse with cold water and drain.
2. Toss with vegetables, olives, cheese and ranch.
3. Chill before packing.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 479 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 526 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 359 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 239 cal

Per adult serving: 479 cal · 12 g protein · 53 g carbs · 25 g fat · 4 g fiber · 743 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.82 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.92 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Grilled cheese and tomato soup

Lunch · Vegetarian

Golden, buttery grilled cheese for dunking into a warm bowl of creamy tomato soup.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 slices white bread
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 4 Tbsp butter
- 3 cans tomato soup
- 1½ cups milk

Steps

1. Butter the outsides of the bread; fill with cheese.
2. Cook over medium heat 3 minutes per side.
3. Heat soup with the milk (and water to make up 1 can of liquid per can).

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 690 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 759 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 518 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 345 cal

Per adult serving: 690 cal · 26 g protein · 71 g carbs · 34 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,663 mg sodium · 19 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.39 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.04 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham and cheese sandwiches

Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Sliced ham and cheddar with crisp lettuce and a swipe of mustard, plus sweet grapes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- ¾ lb sliced ham
- ½ cup shredded cheddar, or 4 slices
- 2 Tbsp mustard
- 2 Tbsp mayo
- ¼ head lettuce
- 2 cups grapes

Steps

1. Build sandwiches with ham, cheese, lettuce, mustard and mayo.
2. Pack with grapes and an ice pack.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 414 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 455 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 310 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 207 cal

Per adult serving: 414 cal · 26 g protein · 45 g carbs · 15 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,402 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.03 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.96 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham and cheese tortilla roll-ups

Lunch · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Ham, cheddar and lettuce rolled snug in tortillas, with cool cucumber spears.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 flour tortillas
- ½ lb sliced ham
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- 2 Tbsp mayo
- ¼ head lettuce
- 1 cucumber, in spears

Steps

1. Spread tortillas with mayo; layer ham, cheese and lettuce.
2. Roll tightly and cut in half. Pack with cucumber spears.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 318 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 350 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 238 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 159 cal

Per adult serving: 318 cal · 17 g protein · 29 g carbs · 15 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,087 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.28 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham and potato chowder

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A thick, creamy chowder of potatoes, smoky ham and sweet corn.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 potatoes, diced
- ½ lb sliced ham, diced
- 1 onion
- 3 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup flour
- 3 cups milk
- 1 can corn
- 2 cubes chicken bouillon *
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook onion in butter 5 minutes; stir in flour.
2. Add potatoes, bouillon and 3 cups water; simmer 15 minutes.
3. Add milk, ham and corn; heat without boiling; stir in cheese.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 362 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 398 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 271 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 181 cal

Per adult serving: 362 cal · 17 g protein · 45 g carbs · 13 g fat · 4 g fiber · 987 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.71 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.24 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham and veggie sandwiches (dairy-free)

Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Ham with crisp lettuce, tomato and cucumber on wheat, plus a crunchy apple.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- ¾ lb sliced ham
- 2 Tbsp mustard
- 2 Tbsp mayo
- ¼ head lettuce
- 1 tomato, sliced
- ½ cucumber, sliced
- 4 apples

Steps

1. Build sandwiches with ham, vegetables, mustard and mayo.
2. Pack with an apple and an ice pack.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 411 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 452 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 308 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 205 cal

Per adult serving: 411 cal · 23 g protein · 59 g carbs · 10 g fat · 9 g fiber · 1,318 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.16 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.21 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham and white bean soup

Lunch, Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A thick, comforting soup of tender white beans, smoky ham and sweet carrots.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- ½ lb sliced ham, chopped
- 3 cans great northern beans, with liquid
- 2 cubes chicken bouillon *
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook onion and carrots in oil 5 minutes.
2. Add ham, beans, bouillon, pepper and 4 cups water; simmer 25 minutes.
3. Mash a cup of beans against the pot to thicken. Good in a thermos.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 408 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 449 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 306 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 204 cal

Per adult serving: 408 cal · 29 g protein · 60 g carbs · 6 g fat · 20 g fiber · 2,122 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.62 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.44 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham salad sandwiches

Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy, savory ham salad with crunchy cucumber on wheat bread.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ¾ lb sliced ham, finely chopped
- 6 Tbsp mayo
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- ½ cucumber, finely diced
- 1/8 onion, minced
- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- ¼ head lettuce

Steps

1. Mix ham, mayo, mustard, cucumber and onion.
2. Pack filling cold with an ice pack; build sandwiches at lunch.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 399 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 439 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 299 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 200 cal

Per adult serving: 399 cal · 22 g protein · 33 g carbs · 20 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,362 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.19 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.56 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hearty vegetable soup

Dinner, Lunch · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A hearty, colorful soup brimming with potatoes, carrots, corn and green beans.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 potatoes, diced
- 3 carrots
- 1 onion
- 1 can corn
- 1 can green beans
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 4 cubes vegetable bouillon *
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Cook onion and carrots in oil 5 minutes.
2. Add potatoes, tomatoes, bouillon, Italian seasoning and 6 cups water; simmer 20 minutes.
3. Add corn and green beans; simmer 5 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 203 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 223 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 152 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 101 cal

Per adult serving: 203 cal · 6 g protein · 40 g carbs · 3 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,195 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.41 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.96 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Homemade chicken nuggets with potato wedges

Dinner, Lunch · Lower-sugar pick

Crunchy homemade chicken nuggets with crispy potato wedges and dipping sauces.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts, bite-size
- ½ cup flour
- 2 eggs
- 4 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- 8 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1½ tsp salt
- 6 potatoes
- 4 Tbsp ketchup
- 4 Tbsp ranch dressing

Steps

1. Toss potato wedges with 3 Tbsp oil and 1 tsp salt; bake at 425°F for 35 minutes.
2. Dredge chicken in flour, egg, then salted crumbs; set on an oiled sheet; drizzle with oil.
3. Bake chicken at 425°F for 15 minutes, turning once, to 165°F. Serve with ketchup and ranch.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 942 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,036 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 707 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 471 cal

Per adult serving: 942 cal · 52 g protein · 88 g carbs · 43 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,460 mg sodium · 7 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $11.98 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.60 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hot dog bun pizzas

Dinner, Lunch, Snack

Toasted buns topped with pizza sauce, sausage and bubbly melted cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 hot dog buns, split open
- 1 jar spaghetti sauce
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- ½ lb pork sausage
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *

Steps

1. Brown sausage; drain.
2. Spread bun halves with sauce; sprinkle Italian seasoning; top with sausage and cheese.
3. Bake at 425°F for 8–10 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 776 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 853 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 582 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 388 cal

Per adult serving: 776 cal · 35 g protein · 69 g carbs · 40 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,865 mg sodium · 11 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.87 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.15 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hot dog mac and cheese

Dinner, Lunch · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy mac and cheese with browned hot dog slices and peppers.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 boxes macaroni and cheese
- ½ cup milk
- 4 Tbsp butter
- 4 beef franks, sliced
- ½ bell pepper

Steps

1. Make mac and cheese per the box.
2. Brown franks and pepper; stir in.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 651 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 716 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 488 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 326 cal

Per adult serving: 651 cal · 20 g protein · 69 g carbs · 32 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,505 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.34 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.16 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hot ham and cheese sliders

Lunch, Dinner, Snack · Lower-sugar pick

Warm, melty ham and cheese sliders brushed with mustard butter.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 hamburger buns
- ¾ lb sliced ham
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 3 Tbsp butter, melted
- 2 Tbsp mustard

Steps

1. Set bun bottoms in a baking dish; layer ham and cheese; add tops.
2. Brush with butter mixed with mustard; cover with foil.
3. Bake at 350°F for 15 minutes; uncover for 5.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 565 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 622 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 424 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 283 cal

Per adult serving: 565 cal · 31 g protein · 55 g carbs · 25 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,668 mg sodium · 7 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.41 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.83 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hot shredded beef sandwiches

Lunch, Dinner · Dairy-free

Tender shredded beef in a tangy sauce piled on soft buns.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned fully cooked beef
- 4 Tbsp ketchup
- 3 tsp brown sugar
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- 6 hamburger buns

Steps

1. Heat canned beef with its juices, ketchup, brown sugar and mustard; shred with a fork; simmer 5 minutes.
2. Pile onto buns.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 525 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 577 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 394 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 262 cal

Per adult serving: 525 cal · 48 g protein · 47 g carbs · 16 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,233 mg sodium · 12 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $12.03 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.62 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Italian beef sandwiches

Dinner, Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender, herby shredded beef with sautéed peppers on soft rolls, with juices for dipping.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3¾ lb beef roast
- 3 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 3 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 2 bell peppers, strips
- 1 onion
- 8 hot dog buns
- 1 tsp salt

Steps

1. Rub roast with salt and half the seasoning; set in a covered pan with bouillon, 3 cups water and the rest of the seasoning.
2. Bake at 300°F for 4 hours until it shreds; shred in the juices.
3. Cook peppers and onion until soft. Pile beef on buns; top with peppers; spoon over juices.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 581 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 639 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 436 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 291 cal

Per adult serving: 581 cal · 45 g protein · 30 g carbs · 30 g fat · 2 g fiber · 974 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $21.19 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $4.61 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Lentil vegetable soup

Lunch, Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A hearty, savory lentil soup with carrots and tomatoes that warms you through.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups dry lentils, rinsed *
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 2 cubes vegetable bouillon *
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook onion and carrots in oil 5 minutes.
2. Add lentils, tomatoes, bouillon, garlic and 6 cups water.
3. Simmer 30 minutes, until lentils are tender. Season.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 240 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 264 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 180 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 120 cal

Per adult serving: 240 cal · 14 g protein · 39 g carbs · 3 g fat · 18 g fiber · 793 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.90 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.63 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Loaded baked potatoes

Lunch, Dinner · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Fluffy baked potatoes loaded with butter, broccoli, melted cheddar and sour cream.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 potatoes
- 4 Tbsp butter
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup sour cream
- 2 cups broccoli florets, steamed
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Bake scrubbed, fork-pricked potatoes at 400°F for 1 hour (or microwave 10–12 minutes).
2. Split; top with butter, broccoli, cheese and sour cream.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 446 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 491 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 335 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 223 cal

Per adult serving: 446 cal · 13 g protein · 42 g carbs · 27 g fat · 5 g fiber · 452 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.33 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.38 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Mac and cheese with ham and broccoli

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy mac and cheese loaded with diced ham and tender broccoli.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 boxes macaroni and cheese
- ¾ cup milk
- 6 Tbsp butter
- ¼ lb sliced ham, diced
- 2 cups broccoli florets, chopped

Steps

1. Make mac and cheese per the box; add broccoli to the pasta water for the last 3 minutes.
2. Stir in ham with the cheese sauce.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 746 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 820 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 559 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 373 cal

Per adult serving: 746 cal · 26 g protein · 104 g carbs · 25 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,822 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.72 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.46 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Meatball subs

Lunch, Dinner

Tender meatballs in marinara with melted cheese, piled into soft buns.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- 1 egg
- 2 tsp Italian seasoning *
- ½ tsp salt
- 1 jar spaghetti sauce
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 8 hot dog buns

Steps

1. Mix beef, crumbs, egg, 1 tsp Italian seasoning and salt; roll 24 meatballs.
2. Bake at 400°F for 15 minutes; simmer in sauce with the rest of the seasoning 10 minutes.
3. Fill buns with meatballs and sauce; top with cheese; broil 2 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 843 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 928 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 632 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 422 cal

Per adult serving: 843 cal · 43 g protein · 76 g carbs · 40 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,791 mg sodium · 12 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $13.65 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.97 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pasta salad with cheese and olives

Lunch, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Chilled pasta tossed with crisp vegetables, olives, cheddar and creamy ranch.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 oz macaroni
- 1 cucumber, diced
- 2 tomatoes, diced
- 1 can black olives, sliced
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 6 Tbsp ranch dressing
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook macaroni; rinse with cold water and drain well.
2. Toss with vegetables, olives, cheese and ranch.
3. Chill. Keeps 3 days.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 479 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 526 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 359 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 239 cal

Per adult serving: 479 cal · 15 g protein · 51 g carbs · 24 g fat · 4 g fiber · 743 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.22 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.57 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

PB&J sandwiches with carrots

Lunch · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

The classic peanut butter and jelly on wheat, with crunchy carrot sticks on the side.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- 8 Tbsp peanut butter
- 6 Tbsp strawberry jam
- 2 carrots, in sticks

Steps

1. Spread peanut butter and jam; close sandwiches.
2. Pack with carrot sticks.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 438 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 481 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 328 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 219 cal

Per adult serving: 438 cal · 16 g protein · 57 g carbs · 18 g fat · 7 g fiber · 449 mg sodium · 21 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.73 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.59 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pigs in a blanket

Lunch, Snack, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy franks wrapped in flaky homemade biscuit dough and baked golden.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 beef franks
- 2 cups flour
- 3 tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp salt
- 5 Tbsp butter, cold
- ¾ cup milk
- 4 Tbsp ketchup
- 2 Tbsp mustard

Steps

1. Make biscuit dough: mix flour, baking powder and salt; cut in butter; stir in milk.
2. Roll ¼ inch thick; cut 8 strips; wrap around franks.
3. Bake at 425°F for 15 minutes. Serve with ketchup and mustard.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 764 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 841 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 573 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 382 cal

Per adult serving: 764 cal · 20 g protein · 60 g carbs · 48 g fat · 2 g fiber · 2,036 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.76 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.25 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pinto bean and ham soup

Lunch, Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A hearty, slow-simmered pinto bean and ham soup.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2½ cups dry pinto beans, soaked overnight
- ½ lb sliced ham
- 1 onion
- 2 carrots
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 1 tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer soaked beans in 8 cups water with onion 1½ hours.
2. Add carrots, tomatoes, ham and seasonings; simmer 30 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 366 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 402 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 274 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 183 cal

Per adult serving: 366 cal · 25 g protein · 61 g carbs · 2 g fat · 15 g fiber · 1,092 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.90 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.06 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pinto bean and rice burritos

Lunch, Dinner · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Seasoned pinto beans, rice and cheese wrapped in soft tortillas.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans pinto beans
- ¾ cup rice (uncooked)
- 8 flour tortillas
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ¾ cup salsa
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *

Steps

1. Cook rice. Mash beans with taco seasoning; heat.
2. Fill tortillas with beans, rice, cheese and salsa; roll; wrap in foil.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 734 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 807 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 551 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 367 cal

Per adult serving: 734 cal · 29 g protein · 115 g carbs · 17 g fat · 14 g fiber · 2,089 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.70 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.46 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pulled pork sandwiches

Dinner, Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go

Slow-roasted pork shredded into a sweet, tangy barbecue sauce on soft buns.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 lb pork roast
- 12 Tbsp ketchup
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 2 Tbsp mustard
- 3 Tbsp white vinegar *
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 1 onion
- 1 tsp salt
- 8 hamburger buns

Steps

1. Rub roasts with salt and garlic; set on sliced onion in a covered pan with 1 cup water; bake at 300°F for 4 hours, until it shreds.
2. Simmer ketchup, brown sugar, mustard and vinegar 10 minutes for the sauce.
3. Shred pork; toss with sauce; pile on buns.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.
To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 657 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 723 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 493 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 329 cal

Per adult serving: 657 cal · 48 g protein · 49 g carbs · 30 g fat · 1 g fiber · 919 mg sodium · 22 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.36 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.25 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sausage pizza quesadillas

Lunch, Snack · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy tortillas layered with pizza sauce, sausage and melted cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 flour tortillas
- 1 can tomato sauce
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- ½ lb pork sausage

Steps

1. Brown sausage; drain.
2. Spread 4 tortillas with tomato sauce mixed with Italian seasoning; add sausage and cheese; top with tortillas.
3. Cook 2–3 minutes per side; cut in wedges.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 706 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 776 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 529 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 353 cal

Per adult serving: 706 cal · 31 g protein · 56 g carbs · 40 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,900 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.69 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.89 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Shredded beef burrito bowls

Lunch, Dinner · Gluten-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender shredded beef over rice with beans, corn, salsa and cheese.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 lb beef roast
- 2 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cans black beans
- 1 can corn
- 1 cup salsa
- ½ head lettuce
- 1 cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Simmer roast covered in water with taco seasoning 3 hours (or use leftover pot roast); shred.
2. Cook rice; heat beans and corn.
3. Build bowls with rice, beef, beans, corn, salsa, lettuce and cheese.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 737 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 810 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 553 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 368 cal

Per adult serving: 737 cal · 47 g protein · 74 g carbs · 28 g fat · 12 g fiber · 1,330 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $18.19 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.95 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sloppy joes

Lunch, Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Sweet and tangy saucy beef piled high on soft buns.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb ground beef
- ½ onion, diced
- ½ bell pepper, diced
- 8 Tbsp ketchup
- 1 can tomato sauce
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- 3 tsp brown sugar
- 6 hamburger buns

Steps

1. Brown beef with onion and pepper; drain.
2. Stir in ketchup, tomato sauce, mustard and brown sugar; simmer 15 minutes.
3. Spoon onto buns. Pack the filling hot in a thermos for lunch.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 494 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 543 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 370 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 247 cal

Per adult serving: 494 cal · 26 g protein · 41 g carbs · 25 g fat · 3 g fiber · 871 mg sodium · 10 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.05 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.19 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Stovetop creamy macaroni and cheese

Dinner, Lunch, Side dish · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Ultra-creamy stovetop mac and cheese made with evaporated milk.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 oz macaroni
- 1 can evaporated milk
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook macaroni; drain.
2. Return to the pot with butter, evaporated milk and cheese; stir over low heat until creamy. Season.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 538 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 591 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 403 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 269 cal

Per adult serving: 538 cal · 23 g protein · 63 g carbs · 22 g fat · 3 g fiber · 522 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.37 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.95 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Taco salad in tortilla bowls

Lunch, Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy tortilla bowls filled with seasoned beef, beans, cheese and fresh toppings.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 flour tortillas
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1 head lettuce, chopped
- 2 tomatoes
- 1 can black beans
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup sour cream
- ½ cup salsa

Steps

1. Brush tortillas with oil; press into oven-safe bowls; bake at 375°F for 10 minutes until crisp.
2. Brown beef with taco seasoning and ½ cup water.
3. Fill bowls with lettuce, beef, beans, tomato, cheese, sour cream and salsa. To go: pack the bowl and fillings separately.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 768 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 845 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 576 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 384 cal

Per adult serving: 768 cal · 40 g protein · 53 g carbs · 45 g fat · 11 g fiber · 1,382 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $16.34 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.55 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tomato rice soup

Lunch, Dinner · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go

Comforting tomato soup with tender rice and Italian herbs.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans tomato soup
- ½ cup rice (uncooked)
- ¼ tsp Italian seasoning *

Steps

1. Cook rice.
2. Heat soup with 3 cans water and Italian seasoning; stir in rice.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 251 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 276 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 188 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 125 cal

Per adult serving: 251 cal · 5 g protein · 56 g carbs · 0 g fat · 4 g fiber · 901 mg sodium · 15 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.71 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.02 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tomato soup with cheese toast

Lunch · Vegetarian

Creamy tomato soup with crispy, cheesy toast on the side.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans tomato soup
- 2 cups milk
- 4 slices white bread
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Heat soup with milk and 1 can water.
2. Top bread with cheese; broil until bubbly; serve alongside.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 358 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 394 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 268 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 179 cal

Per adult serving: 358 cal · 14 g protein · 58 g carbs · 8 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,185 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.13 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.33 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tuna macaroni salad

Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy macaroni salad loaded with tuna and crisp cucumber.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 oz macaroni
- 3 cans tuna
- 8 Tbsp mayo
- ½ cucumber
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook macaroni; rinse cold.
2. Stir in drained tuna, mayo, diced cucumber and salt; chill.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 476 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 523 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 357 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 238 cal

Per adult serving: 476 cal · 27 g protein · 43 g carbs · 22 g fat · 2 g fiber · 595 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.79 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.26 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tuna melts

Lunch, Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy tuna and melted cheddar griddled between golden, buttery bread.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans tuna, drained
- 6 Tbsp mayo
- ¼ onion, minced
- 8 slices white bread
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 3 Tbsp butter
- 1 tomato, sliced

Steps

1. Mix tuna, mayo and onion.
2. Spread on 4 slices of bread; add tomato and cheese; top with bread.
3. Butter the outsides; cook over medium heat 3–4 minutes per side until the cheese melts.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 604 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 664 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 453 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 302 cal

Per adult serving: 604 cal · 38 g protein · 30 g carbs · 36 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,019 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.38 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.04 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tuna salad lettuce wraps

Lunch · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy tuna salad spooned into crisp lettuce cups with crunchy carrot sticks.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans tuna, drained
- 8 Tbsp mayo
- ½ cucumber, diced
- 1 head lettuce, leaves
- 2 carrots, in sticks

Steps

1. Mix tuna, mayo and cucumber.
2. Pack filling cold; spoon into lettuce leaves at lunch. Carrot sticks on the side.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 337 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 371 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 253 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 168 cal

Per adult serving: 337 cal · 28 g protein · 8 g carbs · 21 g fat · 3 g fiber · 576 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.89 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.93 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tuna salad sandwiches

Lunch · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy tuna salad with crunchy cucumber and onion, built fresh on wheat bread.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans tuna, drained
- 8 Tbsp mayo
- ½ cucumber, finely diced
- ¼ onion, finely diced
- 8 slices whole wheat bread
- ¼ head lettuce
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Mix tuna, mayo, cucumber, onion and pepper.
2. Pack filling separately with an ice pack; build sandwiches at lunch.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 473 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 521 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 355 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 237 cal

Per adult serving: 473 cal · 35 g protein · 31 g carbs · 23 g fat · 5 g fiber · 825 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.07 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.76 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

White bean and veggie wraps

Lunch · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Silky white bean spread with crunchy fresh vegetables wrapped in a soft tortilla.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans great northern beans, drained
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- ½ tsp salt
- 4 flour tortillas
- 1 cucumber, sliced
- 2 carrots, grated
- ¼ head lettuce
- 1 tomato, sliced

Steps

1. Mash beans with oil, garlic powder, salt and 2 Tbsp water until smooth.
2. Spread on tortillas; add vegetables; roll tightly and halve.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 459 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 505 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 344 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 229 cal

Per adult serving: 459 cal · 18 g protein · 68 g carbs · 15 g fat · 16 g fiber · 1,365 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $5.71 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.24 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dinners

Baked macaroni with meat sauce

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Macaroni baked in meat sauce with creamy cottage cheese and golden cheddar.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 oz macaroni
- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 jars spaghetti sauce
- 1 cup cottage cheese
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *

Steps

1. Cook macaroni 2 minutes short; drain. Brown beef; drain; add sauce and seasoning.
2. Stir macaroni, sauce and cottage cheese together; spread in a 9x13 pan.
3. Top with cheddar; bake at 375°F for 25 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 590 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 649 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 443 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 295 cal

Per adult serving: 590 cal · 30 g protein · 60 g carbs · 26 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,040 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.14 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.99 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Baked spaghetti

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy spaghetti baked under meat sauce and a golden layer of cheese.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 oz spaghetti
- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 jars spaghetti sauce
- 1 cup sour cream
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 2 Tbsp butter
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- ½ onion

Steps

1. Cook spaghetti; toss with butter and sour cream; spread in a 9x13 pan.
2. Brown beef with onion; drain; add sauce and seasoning; pour over.
3. Top with cheese; bake at 350°F for 30 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 647 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 711 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 485 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 323 cal

Per adult serving: 647 cal · 28 g protein · 61 g carbs · 33 g fat · 7 g fiber · 975 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.18 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.99 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef and broccoli over rice

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender beef and crisp broccoli in a glossy, savory soy sauce over rice.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb stewing beef, thin strips
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 4 cups broccoli florets
- 6 Tbsp soy sauce *
- 2 Tbsp brown sugar
- 3 tsp flour
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 2 cups rice (uncooked)

Steps

1. Cook rice.
2. Stir-fry beef in hot oil 4 minutes; remove. Stir-fry broccoli 3 minutes with 2 Tbsp water.
3. Whisk soy sauce, brown sugar, flour, garlic and ½ cup water; add with beef; simmer 2 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 820 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 902 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 615 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 410 cal

Per adult serving: 820 cal · 43 g protein · 91 g carbs · 30 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,488 mg sodium · 7 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $19.24 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $4.18 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef and noodles

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender beef in a creamy, savory sauce over soft egg noodles.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned fully cooked beef
- 2 cans cream of mushroom soup
- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- 1 cup milk
- ½ onion
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook onion in a little of the beef juices; add beef, soup, milk and pepper; simmer 10 minutes.
2. Toss with cooked noodles.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 515 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 566 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 386 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 257 cal

Per adult serving: 515 cal · 38 g protein · 50 g carbs · 18 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,196 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.45 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.27 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef and rice stuffed peppers

Dinner · Gluten-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Sweet peppers filled with seasoned beef and rice, baked under melted cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 bell peppers, halved
- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 cup rice (uncooked)
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- ½ onion
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 1 cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Cook rice. Brown beef with onion; drain; stir in rice, half the tomatoes and the seasoning.
2. Fill pepper halves; set in a baking dish; pour the rest of the tomatoes around.
3. Cover and bake at 375°F for 35 minutes; add cheese and bake 10 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 653 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 718 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 489 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 326 cal

Per adult serving: 653 cal · 33 g protein · 55 g carbs · 32 g fat · 6 g fiber · 683 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $17.65 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.84 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef enchilada casserole

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Layers of tortillas, seasoned beef, beans and melted cheese baked together.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1 cup dehydrated refried bean flakes
- 2 cans tomato sauce
- 6 flour tortillas
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- ½ cup sour cream
- 1 can black olives

Steps

1. Brown beef; drain; add 1 Tbsp taco seasoning and ½ cup water. Make refried beans with 1¼ cups boiling water.
2. Simmer tomato sauce with the rest of the seasoning.
3. Layer sauce, tortillas, beans, beef and cheese twice in a 9x13 pan; top with olives.
4. Bake at 375°F for 25 minutes. Serve with sour cream.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 674 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 741 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 505 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 337 cal

Per adult serving: 674 cal · 33 g protein · 51 g carbs · 38 g fat · 9 g fiber · 1,927 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $11.97 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.60 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef stew over mashed potatoes

Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Savory beef stew ladled over fluffy mashed potatoes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans canned beef stew
- 1¼ cups instant potato flakes
- 5/8 cup milk
- 2 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Make mashed potatoes per the box.
2. Heat stew; ladle over potatoes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 521 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 573 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 391 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 261 cal

Per adult serving: 521 cal · 21 g protein · 50 g carbs · 27 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,984 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $11.00 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.39 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef stew with biscuits

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender beef and vegetables in a rich, savory gravy with fluffy homemade biscuits.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 lb stewing beef
- 2¼ cups flour, 3 Tbsp for stew, 2 cups for biscuits
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 onion
- 4 potatoes, chunks
- 4 carrots, chunks
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 2 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 2 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 6 Tbsp butter
- ¾ cup milk

Steps

1. Toss beef in 3 Tbsp flour, 1 tsp salt and pepper; brown in oil in batches.
2. Add onion, tomatoes, bouillon and 4 cups water; cover and simmer 1½ hours.
3. Add potatoes and carrots; simmer 30–40 minutes more.
4. Biscuits: mix 2 cups flour, baking powder and 1 tsp salt; cut in butter; add milk; cut and bake at 450°F for 10–12 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 789 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 868 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 592 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 394 cal

Per adult serving: 789 cal · 39 g protein · 73 g carbs · 37 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,828 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $17.62 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.83 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef stroganoff

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender beef in a creamy mushroom and sour cream sauce over egg noodles.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb stewing beef, thin strips
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 onion
- 2 Tbsp flour
- 1 cube chicken bouillon *
- 2 cans cream of mushroom soup
- 1 cup sour cream
- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Brown beef in oil; add onion and cook 5 minutes.
2. Stir in flour, then soup, bouillon and 1 cup water; cover and simmer 45 minutes until tender.
3. Stir in sour cream; serve over noodles.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 661 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 728 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 496 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 331 cal

Per adult serving: 661 cal · 32 g protein · 53 g carbs · 35 g fat · 3 g fiber · 948 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $14.29 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.11 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Beef tacos with salsa rice

Dinner · Gluten-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Seasoned ground beef tacos with crisp lettuce, cheese and zesty salsa rice.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 12 corn tortillas
- ½ head lettuce, shredded
- 2 tomatoes, chopped
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup sour cream
- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 1 cup salsa

Steps

1. Cook rice with ½ cup of the salsa in place of ½ cup water.
2. Brown beef; drain. Add taco seasoning and 2/3 cup water; simmer 5 minutes.
3. Warm tortillas; fill with beef and toppings.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 929 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,022 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 697 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 465 cal

Per adult serving: 929 cal · 39 g protein · 101 g carbs · 41 g fat · 8 g fiber · 1,109 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $16.03 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.48 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Black bean stuffed peppers

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender peppers stuffed with black beans, rice, corn and zesty salsa.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 bell peppers, halved
- 1 can black beans, drained
- 1 cup rice (uncooked)
- 1 can corn, drained
- 1 cup salsa
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *

Steps

1. Cook rice; mix with beans, corn, half the salsa and the taco seasoning.
2. Fill pepper halves; set in a baking dish with the rest of the salsa.
3. Cover and bake at 375°F for 40 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 374 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 411 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 280 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 187 cal

Per adult serving: 374 cal · 13 g protein · 78 g carbs · 2 g fat · 13 g fiber · 1,158 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.70 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.11 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Black bean tacos

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Smoky seasoned black beans in warm tortillas with fresh lettuce, tomato and salsa.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans black beans, drained
- 2 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- ½ onion, diced
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 12 corn tortillas
- ½ head lettuce, shredded
- 2 tomatoes, chopped
- 1 cup salsa
- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)

Steps

1. Cook rice as on the package.
2. Cook onion in oil 4 minutes; add beans, taco seasoning and ½ cup water; mash lightly and simmer 5 minutes.
3. Fill warm tortillas with beans, lettuce, tomato and salsa.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 797 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 876 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 597 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 398 cal

Per adult serving: 797 cal · 30 g protein · 154 g carbs · 8 g fat · 28 g fiber · 1,894 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.35 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.03 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Breaded chicken with spaghetti and sauce

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy breaded chicken topped with sauce and melted cheese over spaghetti.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts, thin cutlets
- ½ cup flour
- 2 eggs
- 4 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- 2 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 6 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 jar spaghetti sauce
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 16 oz spaghetti

Steps

1. Dredge chicken in flour, then beaten egg, then crumbs mixed with Italian seasoning.
2. Fry in oil 4 minutes per side, to 165°F.
3. Top with sauce and cheese; broil 2 minutes. Serve over spaghetti with the rest of the sauce.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 782 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 860 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 586 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 391 cal

Per adult serving: 782 cal · 46 g protein · 85 g carbs · 29 g fat · 7 g fiber · 792 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.08 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.97 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cheese-free sausage and veggie pizza

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Homemade pizza loaded with sausage, peppers, onions and olives, no cheese needed.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 cups flour
- 2 packs yeast
- 2½ tsp sugar
- 2 tsp salt
- 6 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 cans tomato sauce
- 2 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- ½ lb pork sausage
- 1 bell pepper, sliced
- ½ onion, sliced
- 1 can black olives, sliced
- ½ head lettuce
- 1 cucumber
- 2 tomatoes
- 2 Tbsp white vinegar *

Steps

1. Make the dough as for Homemade pizza; let rise 1 hour.
2. Brown sausage; drain. Simmer tomato sauce with Italian seasoning and half the garlic.
3. Top crusts with sauce, sausage, vegetables and olives; drizzle with 1 Tbsp oil; bake at 450°F for 15–18 minutes.
4. Salad: toss vegetables with 2 Tbsp oil, vinegar, salt and the rest of the garlic powder.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 1,202 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,323 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 902 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 601 cal

Per adult serving: 1,202 cal · 34 g protein · 175 g carbs · 41 g fat · 13 g fiber · 2,745 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $14.63 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.18 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cheeseburger macaroni

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Cheesy macaroni and seasoned beef that tastes just like a cheeseburger.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- ½ onion
- 12 oz macaroni
- 2 cups milk
- 1 can tomato sauce
- 2 Tbsp ketchup
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Brown beef with onion; drain.
2. Add macaroni, milk, tomato sauce, ketchup, mustard, salt and 1½ cups water; cover and simmer 12 minutes, stirring.
3. Stir in cheese until melted.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 619 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 681 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 465 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 310 cal

Per adult serving: 619 cal · 34 g protein · 54 g carbs · 30 g fat · 4 g fiber · 929 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.14 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.99 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cheesy broccoli rice casserole

Dinner · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy rice and tender broccoli baked under a blanket of melted cheddar.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cans cream of mushroom soup
- 1 cup milk
- 4 cups broccoli florets, chopped
- 1½ cups shredded cheddar
- ½ onion, diced
- ¼ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Stir rice, soup, milk, onion, pepper and 2 cups water in a greased 9x13 pan; cover.
2. Bake at 375°F for 45 minutes.
3. Stir in broccoli; top with cheese; bake uncovered 15 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 413 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 454 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 309 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 206 cal

Per adult serving: 413 cal · 15 g protein · 52 g carbs · 16 g fat · 3 g fiber · 917 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.18 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.34 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cheesy chicken and broccoli rice bake

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A creamy, cheesy bake of chicken, rice and broccoli with a golden top.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cans canned chicken breast pieces
- 2 cans cream of chicken soup
- 1 cup milk
- 4 cups broccoli florets, chopped
- 1½ cups shredded cheddar
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Stir rice, soup, milk, 2 cups water and pepper in a greased 9x13 pan; cover with foil.
2. Bake at 375°F for 45 minutes.
3. Stir in chicken and broccoli; top with cheese; bake uncovered 15 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 839 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 923 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 629 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 419 cal

Per adult serving: 839 cal · 59 g protein · 80 g carbs · 31 g fat · 4 g fiber · 2,125 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $17.08 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.71 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken and dumplings

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender chicken and fluffy dumplings simmered in a rich, savory broth.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts
- 4 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 3 carrots
- 1 onion
- 2 cups flour
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 3 Tbsp butter
- ¾ cup milk
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Simmer chicken, carrots, onion and bouillon in 8 cups water 25 minutes; shred chicken.
2. Mix flour, baking powder and salt; cut in butter; stir in milk.
3. Drop spoonfuls into the simmering broth; cover and cook 15 minutes without lifting the lid.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 382 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 420 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 287 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 191 cal

Per adult serving: 382 cal · 32 g protein · 39 g carbs · 10 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,385 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.18 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.34 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken and pepper quesadillas

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy tortillas stuffed with seasoned chicken, peppers and gooey cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb chicken breasts
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 8 flour tortillas
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 1 bell pepper
- ½ onion
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ cup sour cream

Steps

1. Cook diced chicken with peppers and onion; add taco seasoning and ¼ cup water.
2. Fill 4 tortillas with filling and cheese; top with the rest.
3. Cook 2–3 minutes per side; cut and serve with salsa and sour cream.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 727 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 800 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 546 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 364 cal

Per adult serving: 727 cal · 49 g protein · 56 g carbs · 34 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,542 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $12.74 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.77 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken and rice casserole with crumb topping

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy chicken and rice baked under a buttery, golden crumb topping.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts, diced
- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cans cream of mushroom soup
- 1 cup milk
- 2 cups broccoli florets
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 3 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- 3 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Stir rice, soup, milk and 2 cups water in a 9x13 pan; lay chicken on top; cover with foil.
2. Bake at 375°F for 50 minutes.
3. Stir in broccoli; top with cheese and crumbs tossed in melted butter; bake uncovered 15 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 586 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 644 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 439 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 293 cal

Per adult serving: 586 cal · 39 g protein · 56 g carbs · 22 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,038 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.61 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.09 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken pot pie with biscuit crust

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy chicken and vegetables under a golden, flaky biscuit crust.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts, diced
- 2 cans cream of chicken soup
- 1¾ cups milk
- 2 carrots, diced
- ½ onion
- 1 can corn
- 1 can green beans
- 2 cups flour
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 7 Tbsp butter
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook chicken, carrots and onion in 1 Tbsp butter 8 minutes.
2. Stir in soup, 1 cup milk, drained corn and green beans and pepper; pour into a 9x13 pan.
3. Biscuits: mix flour, baking powder and salt; cut in 6 Tbsp butter; add ¾ cup milk; drop over filling.
4. Bake at 400°F for 25 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 603 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 663 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 452 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 301 cal

Per adult serving: 603 cal · 37 g protein · 58 g carbs · 25 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,874 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.35 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.03 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken stir-fry over rice

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender chicken and crisp vegetables in a glossy honey-soy sauce over rice.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rice (uncooked)
- 1½ lb chicken breasts, bite-size
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 4 cups broccoli florets
- 1 bell pepper
- 2 carrots, thin slices
- 1 onion
- 5 Tbsp soy sauce *
- 2 Tbsp honey
- 3 tsp flour
- ½ tsp garlic powder *

Steps

1. Cook rice.
2. Stir-fry chicken in hot oil 6–7 minutes; remove.
3. Stir-fry vegetables 4 minutes.
4. Whisk soy sauce, honey, flour, garlic and ½ cup water; add with chicken and simmer 2 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 720 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 792 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 540 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 360 cal

Per adult serving: 720 cal · 50 g protein · 100 g carbs · 12 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,296 mg sodium · 9 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $14.17 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.08 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken tacos with black beans

Dinner · Gluten-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender shredded chicken in warm corn tortillas with fresh toppings and black beans.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts
- 2 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 12 corn tortillas
- ½ head lettuce, shredded
- 2 tomatoes, chopped
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ cup sour cream
- 2 cans black beans

Steps

1. Simmer chicken covered in water 20 minutes, to 165°F; shred.
2. Stir in taco seasoning and ½ cup water; simmer 3 minutes.
3. Warm tortillas; fill with chicken and toppings. Heat black beans for the side.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 773 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 850 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 580 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 386 cal

Per adult serving: 773 cal · 64 g protein · 78 g carbs · 23 g fat · 20 g fiber · 1,617 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $15.88 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.45 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chicken, broccoli and rice skillet

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Tender chicken, fluffy rice and bright broccoli cooked together in one skillet.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts, bite-size
- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 4 cups broccoli florets
- ½ onion, diced
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Brown chicken and onion in oil 6 minutes.
2. Add rice, garlic, bouillon, pepper and 3 cups water; cover and simmer 18 minutes.
3. Lay broccoli on top; cover 5 minutes more; stir.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 565 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 622 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 424 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 283 cal

Per adult serving: 565 cal · 46 g protein · 65 g carbs · 12 g fat · 4 g fiber · 597 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $11.09 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.41 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chickpea and potato stew

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A hearty, tomato-rich stew of chickpeas and potatoes served over rice.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans chickpeas, drained *
- 3 potatoes, cubed
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 1 onion
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 1 cube vegetable bouillon *
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 cups rice (uncooked)

Steps

1. Cook onion in oil 5 minutes.
2. Add potatoes, chickpeas, tomatoes, garlic, bouillon and 2 cups water; simmer 25 minutes.
3. Serve over cooked rice.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 727 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 800 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 545 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 364 cal

Per adult serving: 727 cal · 21 g protein · 143 g carbs · 7 g fat · 15 g fiber · 1,116 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.00 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.52 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chili mac

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty chili and macaroni simmered together and topped with melted cheese.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- ½ onion
- 8 oz macaroni
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 1 can tomato sauce
- 2 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1½ cups shredded cheddar
- ½ cup sour cream

Steps

1. Brown beef with onion; drain.
2. Add tomatoes, sauce, seasoning and 2 cups water; boil; stir in macaroni.
3. Cover and simmer 12 minutes; stir in 1 cup cheese. Top with sour cream and cheese.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 540 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 594 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 405 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 270 cal

Per adult serving: 540 cal · 28 g protein · 43 g carbs · 29 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,085 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.83 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.14 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chili over baked potatoes

Dinner · Gluten-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty homemade chili ladled over fluffy baked potatoes with cheese and sour cream.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2½ cups dry pinto beans, soaked overnight
- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 onion, diced
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 2 cans tomato sauce
- 3 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 6 potatoes
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup sour cream

Steps

1. Simmer soaked beans in fresh water 1½ hours until tender; drain.
2. Brown beef with onion and pepper; drain. Add beans, tomatoes, sauce, seasoning and 2 cups water; simmer 30 minutes.
3. Bake potatoes at 400°F for 1 hour; split and top with chili, cheese and sour cream.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 633 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 697 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 475 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 317 cal

Per adult serving: 633 cal · 33 g protein · 82 g carbs · 20 g fat · 17 g fiber · 1,126 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.61 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.31 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Creamy chicken and noodles

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Tender chicken and vegetables in a creamy sauce over soft egg noodles.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- 1½ lb chicken breasts, bite-size
- 2 cans cream of chicken soup
- 1 cup milk
- 2 carrots, sliced
- ½ onion, diced
- 2 cups broccoli florets
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook chicken, carrots and onion in oil 8 minutes.
2. Stir in soup, milk, pepper and 1 cup water; simmer 10 minutes; add broccoli for the last 4.
3. Toss with cooked noodles.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 519 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 571 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 389 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 260 cal

Per adult serving: 519 cal · 39 g protein · 56 g carbs · 15 g fat · 4 g fiber · 862 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.39 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.04 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Creamy chicken enchiladas

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tortillas filled with seasoned chicken and baked in a creamy, cheesy sauce.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts
- 1 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 2 cans cream of chicken soup
- 1 cup sour cream
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 8 flour tortillas
- 1 cup salsa

Steps

1. Simmer chicken 20 minutes; shred; mix with taco seasoning, 1 cup cheese and half the salsa.
2. Mix soup and sour cream; spread a little in a 9x13 pan.
3. Fill and roll tortillas; set seam-side down; cover with the rest of the sauce, salsa and cheese.
4. Bake at 350°F for 25 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 665 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 731 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 498 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 332 cal

Per adult serving: 665 cal · 44 g protein · 47 g carbs · 34 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,945 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $11.39 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.48 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Creamy garlic chicken pasta with broccoli

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Tender chicken and broccoli in a creamy garlic sauce tossed with pasta.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 oz spaghetti
- 1½ lb chicken breasts, bite-size
- 4 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup flour
- 3 cups milk
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 3 cups broccoli florets
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook pasta, adding broccoli for the last 3 minutes; drain.
2. Brown chicken in 1 Tbsp butter; remove. Melt the rest, stir in flour, then milk and seasonings; simmer until thick.
3. Stir in cheese and chicken; toss with pasta and broccoli.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 644 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 708 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 483 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 322 cal

Per adult serving: 644 cal · 45 g protein · 70 g carbs · 21 g fat · 4 g fiber · 516 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.15 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.99 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Crispy corn tortilla pizzas

Dinner · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy corn tortillas topped with sauce, melted cheese and veggies for quick mini pizzas.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 12 corn tortillas
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 can tomato sauce
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- 1 can black olives, sliced

Steps

1. Brush tortillas with oil; bake at 425°F for 5 minutes until crisp.
2. Spread with tomato sauce mixed with Italian seasoning; add cheese, pepper and olives.
3. Bake 6–8 minutes more, until bubbly.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 533 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 587 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 400 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 267 cal

Per adult serving: 533 cal · 21 g protein · 45 g carbs · 32 g fat · 8 g fiber · 1,107 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.72 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.90 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free beef stew with drop biscuits

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender beef stew with vegetables and fluffy drop biscuits, all dairy-free.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 lb stewing beef
- 2¼ cups flour, 3 Tbsp for stew, 2 cups for biscuits
- 7 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 onion
- 4 potatoes
- 4 carrots
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 2 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 2 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 3 tsp baking powder
- ¾ cup soy or oat milk *

Steps

1. Toss beef in 3 Tbsp flour, 1 tsp salt and pepper; brown in 2 Tbsp oil.
2. Add onion, tomatoes, bouillon and 4 cups water; simmer covered 1½ hours; add potatoes and carrots for 30–40 minutes.
3. Biscuits: mix 2 cups flour, baking powder, 1 tsp salt, 5 Tbsp oil and plant milk; drop on a sheet; bake at 450°F for 12 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 782 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 860 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 586 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 391 cal

Per adult serving: 782 cal · 39 g protein · 72 g carbs · 38 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,735 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $17.33 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.77 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free beef tacos with beans and rice

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Seasoned beef tacos with fresh lettuce and tomato, salsa rice and beans.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 12 corn tortillas
- ½ head lettuce, shredded
- 2 tomatoes, chopped
- 1 cup salsa
- 1½ cups rice (uncooked)
- 1 can black beans

Steps

1. Cook rice with ½ cup salsa in place of ½ cup water.
2. Brown beef; drain; add taco seasoning and 2/3 cup water; simmer 5 minutes.
3. Fill warm tortillas with beef, lettuce, tomato and salsa. Heat beans for the side.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 856 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 942 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 642 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 428 cal

Per adult serving: 856 cal · 38 g protein · 117 g carbs · 26 g fat · 15 g fiber · 1,269 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $14.72 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.20 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free chili over baked potatoes

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty homemade chili over fluffy baked potatoes, topped with salsa.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2½ cups dry pinto beans, soaked overnight
- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 onion, diced
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 2 cans tomato sauce
- 3 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 6 potatoes
- 1 cup salsa

Steps

1. Simmer soaked beans 1½ hours until tender; drain.
2. Brown beef with onion and pepper; drain; add beans, tomatoes, sauce, seasoning and 2 cups water; simmer 30 minutes.
3. Bake potatoes at 400°F for 1 hour; split and top with chili and salsa.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 557 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 613 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 418 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 279 cal

Per adult serving: 557 cal · 29 g protein · 83 g carbs · 12 g fat · 17 g fiber · 1,256 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.99 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.17 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free pork roast with mashed potatoes

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Garlicky pork roast with savory gravy and creamy dairy-free mashed potatoes.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 lb pork roast
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1½ tsp salt
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 onion, sliced
- 2 Tbsp flour
- 1 cube chicken bouillon *
- 4 cups instant potato flakes
- 2 cups soy or oat milk *

Steps

1. Rub roasts with salt, garlic powder and pepper; brown in 1 Tbsp oil.
2. Bake on onions with 1 cup water, covered, at 325°F for about 2 hours, to 145°F.
3. Whisk flour and bouillon into 1 cup cold water; add to pan juices; simmer for gravy.
4. Make potatoes with plant milk and 2 Tbsp oil.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 610 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 672 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 458 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 305 cal

Per adult serving: 610 cal · 48 g protein · 28 g carbs · 34 g fat · 3 g fiber · 722 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.22 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.22 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free shepherd's pie

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Savory beef and vegetables under fluffy mashed potatoes made without dairy.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned fully cooked beef
- 1 onion, diced
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 Tbsp flour
- 1 cube chicken bouillon *
- 1 can corn
- 1 can green beans
- 3 cups instant potato flakes
- 1½ cups soy or oat milk *
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook onion in 1 Tbsp oil; stir in flour, beef with juices, bouillon and ½ cup water; simmer until thick.
2. Stir in drained vegetables; spread in a 9x13 pan.
3. Make potatoes with plant milk, 2 Tbsp oil, salt and water; spread on top.
4. Bake at 375°F for 25 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 437 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 480 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 328 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 218 cal

Per adult serving: 437 cal · 34 g protein · 39 g carbs · 17 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,145 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.76 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.12 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free tuna noodle skillet

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Tuna and noodles in a creamy sauce made with plant milk.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ onion, diced
- 3 Tbsp flour
- 2 cups soy or oat milk *
- 1 cube vegetable bouillon *
- 3 cans tuna, drained
- 1 can corn
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook noodles; drain.
2. Cook onion in oil 4 minutes; stir in flour, then plant milk, bouillon and pepper; simmer until thick.
3. Add tuna, corn and noodles; heat through.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 633 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 696 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 475 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 316 cal

Per adult serving: 633 cal · 38 g protein · 80 g carbs · 19 g fat · 6 g fiber · 731 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.38 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.82 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Franks and mac and cheese bake

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy mac and cheese with sliced franks under a crunchy buttered crumb topping.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 boxes macaroni and cheese
- ¾ cup milk
- 8 Tbsp butter
- 8 beef franks, sliced
- 2 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- 1 cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Make mac and cheese per the box; stir in franks and half the cheddar.
2. Spread in a baking dish; top with crumbs tossed in 2 Tbsp melted butter and the rest of the cheese.
3. Bake at 375°F for 20 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 842 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 926 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 632 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 421 cal

Per adult serving: 842 cal · 27 g protein · 74 g carbs · 48 g fat · 2 g fiber · 1,864 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.64 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.44 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Gluten-free chicken stir-fry

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Chicken and crunchy vegetables in a sweet, savory tamari glaze over rice.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rice (uncooked)
- 1½ lb chicken breasts, bite-size
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 4 cups broccoli florets
- 1 bell pepper
- 2 carrots, thin slices
- 1 onion
- 5 Tbsp tamari *
- 2 Tbsp honey
- ½ tsp garlic powder *

Steps

1. Cook rice.
2. Stir-fry chicken in hot oil 6–7 minutes; remove.
3. Stir-fry vegetables 4 minutes.
4. Add tamari, honey, garlic and ¼ cup water with the chicken; simmer 2 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 714 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 785 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 535 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 357 cal

Per adult serving: 714 cal · 51 g protein · 98 g carbs · 12 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,359 mg sodium · 9 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $15.15 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.29 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Gluten-free spaghetti with meat sauce

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Gluten-free pasta smothered in a savory, slow-simmered meat sauce.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 oz gluten-free pasta *
- 1 lb ground beef
- ½ onion, diced
- 2 jars spaghetti sauce
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- ½ tsp garlic powder *

Steps

1. Brown beef with onion; drain. Add sauce and seasonings; simmer 15 minutes.
2. Cook gluten-free pasta per the box; drain and toss with sauce.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 905 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 996 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 679 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 453 cal

Per adult serving: 905 cal · 34 g protein · 123 g carbs · 33 g fat · 13 g fiber · 1,526 mg sodium · 10 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $16.84 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.66 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham and noodle casserole

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Egg noodles and ham in a creamy, cheesy sauce with a crunchy topping.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- ¾ lb sliced ham, diced
- 2 cans cream of chicken soup
- 1 cup milk
- 1½ cups shredded cheddar
- 1 can corn
- 2 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- 2 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Cook noodles 2 minutes short; drain.
2. Stir in soup, milk, ham, corn and 1 cup cheese; spread in a 9x13 pan.
3. Top with crumbs tossed in melted butter and the rest of the cheese; bake at 350°F for 30 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 608 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 669 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 456 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 304 cal

Per adult serving: 608 cal · 30 g protein · 65 g carbs · 26 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,731 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.80 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.91 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham fried rice

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Savory fried rice with smoky ham, scrambled egg and colorful vegetables.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rice (uncooked), cooked a day ahead
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ lb sliced ham, diced
- 3 eggs
- 2 carrots, diced
- 1 onion, diced
- 1 can corn
- 4 Tbsp soy sauce *

Steps

1. Scramble eggs in 1 Tbsp oil; remove.
2. Cook carrots and onion in the rest of the oil 5 minutes; add ham and corn.
3. Add cold rice; stir-fry 5 minutes; stir in eggs and soy sauce.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 603 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 663 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 452 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 301 cal

Per adult serving: 603 cal · 24 g protein · 95 g carbs · 14 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,755 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $6.79 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.48 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hamburger steaks with onion gravy

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy beef patties smothered in a rich onion gravy with mashed potatoes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 lb ground beef
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 2 onions, sliced
- 5 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup flour
- 2 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 3 cups instant potato flakes
- 1½ cups milk

Steps

1. Shape beef into 6 oval patties; season; brown 4 minutes per side; remove.
2. Cook onions in 2 Tbsp butter 10 minutes; stir in flour, then bouillon and 2 cups water; simmer until thick.
3. Return patties; simmer 10 minutes. Make potatoes with milk and 3 Tbsp butter.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 641 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 705 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 481 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 321 cal

Per adult serving: 641 cal · 33 g protein · 35 g carbs · 41 g fat · 3 g fiber · 919 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $12.17 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.65 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hamburgers with potato wedges

Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy cheeseburgers with all the fixings and crispy seasoned potato wedges.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 lb ground beef
- 2 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 8 hamburger buns
- 1 cup shredded cheddar, or 8 slices
- ½ head lettuce
- 2 tomatoes
- ½ onion
- 4 Tbsp ketchup
- 2 Tbsp mustard
- 6 potatoes
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp garlic powder *

Steps

1. Cut potatoes into wedges; toss with oil, garlic powder and 1 tsp salt; bake at 425°F for 35 minutes, turning once.
2. Shape beef into 8 patties; season; cook 4 minutes per side to 160°F, adding cheese the last minute.
3. Serve on buns with toppings.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 901 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 991 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 676 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 451 cal

Per adult serving: 901 cal · 43 g protein · 80 g carbs · 46 g fat · 7 g fiber · 1,460 mg sodium · 7 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $16.77 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.65 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Herb baked chicken with rice and green beans

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Herb-crusted baked chicken, juicy inside, served with fluffy rice and green beans.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 lb chicken breasts
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 2 cups rice (uncooked)
- 2 cans green beans

Steps

1. Rub chicken with oil and seasonings; bake at 400°F for 22–25 minutes, to 165°F.
2. Cook rice; heat green beans.
3. Slice chicken and serve.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 567 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 624 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 425 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 283 cal

Per adult serving: 567 cal · 57 g protein · 55 g carbs · 11 g fat · 3 g fiber · 870 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $11.22 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.44 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Homemade pizza with salad

Dinner · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Homemade crust with tangy sauce, melted cheese, peppers and olives, plus a crisp salad.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 cups flour
- 2 packs yeast
- 2½ tsp sugar
- 2 tsp salt
- 4 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 cans tomato sauce
- 2 tsp Italian seasoning *
- ½ tsp garlic powder *
- 3 cups shredded cheddar
- 1 bell pepper, sliced
- ½ onion, sliced
- 1 can black olives, sliced
- ½ head lettuce
- 1 cucumber
- 2 tomatoes
- 6 Tbsp ranch dressing

Steps

1. Dissolve yeast and sugar in 2 cups warm water 5 minutes; add flour, salt and 2 Tbsp oil; knead 5 minutes.
2. Cover and let rise 1 hour. Simmer tomato sauce with seasonings 10 minutes.
3. Divide dough; press onto 2 oiled baking sheets; top with sauce, cheese and vegetables.
4. Bake at 450°F for 15–18 minutes. Toss lettuce, cucumber and tomato with ranch.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 1,423 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,566 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 1,067 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 712 cal

Per adult serving: 1,423 cal · 47 g protein · 177 g carbs · 58 g fat · 13 g fiber · 3,115 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $17.08 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.71 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Honey garlic pork with rice and broccoli

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go

Juicy pork slices in a sticky honey garlic glaze with rice and broccoli.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 lb pork roast, sliced ½ inch
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 4 Tbsp honey
- 4 Tbsp soy sauce *
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 3 tsp flour
- 2 cups rice (uncooked)
- 4 cups broccoli florets

Steps

1. Cook rice; steam broccoli.
2. Brown pork slices in oil 3 minutes per side, to 145°F.
3. Whisk honey, soy sauce, garlic, flour and ¼ cup water; add to pan; simmer until glossy.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.
To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 911 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,002 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 683 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 455 cal

Per adult serving: 911 cal · 53 g protein · 101 g carbs · 32 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,061 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $14.08 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.06 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hot dogs with pork and beans

Dinner · Dairy-free

Juicy hot dogs in soft buns with sweet, saucy pork and beans.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 beef franks
- 8 hot dog buns
- 2 cans pork and beans
- 4 Tbsp ketchup
- 2 Tbsp mustard

Steps

1. Simmer franks 5 minutes.
2. Heat the pork and beans.
3. Serve franks in buns with ketchup, mustard and beans on the side.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 910 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,001 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 683 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 455 cal

Per adult serving: 910 cal · 33 g protein · 111 g carbs · 38 g fat · 13 g fiber · 2,525 mg sodium · 25 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.48 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.84 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Lentil shepherd's pie

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Hearty lentils and vegetables baked under creamy, golden mashed potatoes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups dry lentils *
- 2 cubes vegetable bouillon *
- 1 onion, diced
- 2 carrots, diced
- 1 can corn
- 1 can green beans
- 1 can tomato sauce
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 3 cups instant potato flakes
- 1½ cups soy or oat milk *
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer lentils in 4 cups water with bouillon 25 minutes until tender.
2. Cook onion and carrots in 1 Tbsp oil 6 minutes; stir in lentils, tomato sauce and drained vegetables.
3. Make potatoes with plant milk, 2 Tbsp oil, salt and water; spread over filling.
4. Bake at 375°F for 25 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 444 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 488 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 333 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 222 cal

Per adult serving: 444 cal · 20 g protein · 73 g carbs · 9 g fat · 22 g fiber · 1,179 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.89 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.06 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Macaroni and beef goulash

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Macaroni and seasoned beef simmered in tomato sauce and topped with cheddar.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- 8 oz macaroni
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 1 can tomato sauce
- 1 onion
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- ½ tsp garlic powder *
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 1 can corn

Steps

1. Brown beef with onion; drain.
2. Add tomatoes, sauce, seasonings and 2 cups water; bring to a boil.
3. Stir in macaroni; cover and simmer 12 minutes. Stir in corn; top with cheese.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 497 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 547 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 373 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 249 cal

Per adult serving: 497 cal · 26 g protein · 49 g carbs · 23 g fat · 6 g fiber · 901 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.29 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.02 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Meatloaf with mashed potatoes

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy, savory meatloaf with a sweet tangy glaze and creamy mashed potatoes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 lb ground beef
- 3 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- 1 egg
- 1½ cups milk
- ½ onion, minced
- 6 Tbsp ketchup
- 2 Tbsp brown sugar
- 1 Tbsp mustard
- 1½ tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 6 potatoes
- 4 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Mix beef, crumbs, egg, ½ cup milk, onion, 2 Tbsp ketchup, 1 tsp salt and pepper; shape a loaf in a 9x13 pan.
2. Mix the rest of the ketchup, brown sugar and mustard; spread on top. Bake at 350°F for 1 hour, to 160°F.
3. Boil peeled potatoes 15 minutes; mash with butter, 1 cup milk and salt.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 734 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 808 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 551 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 367 cal

Per adult serving: 734 cal · 36 g protein · 58 g carbs · 41 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,048 mg sodium · 9 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $13.50 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.93 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pinto beans and rice with sausage

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Savory pinto beans simmered with sausage and peppers, spooned over rice.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cans pinto beans
- 1 lb pork sausage
- 1 onion
- 1 bell pepper
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 2 cups rice (uncooked)

Steps

1. Brown sausage with onion and pepper; drain.
2. Add beans with liquid, tomatoes and garlic; simmer 20 minutes.
3. Serve over cooked rice.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 681 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 749 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 511 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 340 cal

Per adult serving: 681 cal · 26 g protein · 94 g carbs · 21 g fat · 14 g fiber · 1,455 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.44 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.83 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pork roast with mashed potatoes

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy, garlicky pork roast with silky gravy and creamy mashed potatoes.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 lb pork roast
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 onion, sliced
- 2 Tbsp flour
- 1 cube chicken bouillon *
- 4 cups instant potato flakes
- 2 cups milk
- 4 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Rub roasts with salt, garlic powder and pepper; brown in oil.
2. Set on onions with 1 cup water in a covered pan; bake at 325°F for about 2 hours, to 145°F; rest 10 minutes.
3. Whisk flour and bouillon into 1 cup cold water; stir into pan juices; simmer 3 minutes.
4. Make potatoes with milk and butter per the box.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 642 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 706 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 481 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 321 cal

Per adult serving: 642 cal · 48 g protein · 30 g carbs · 36 g fat · 2 g fiber · 629 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.24 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.23 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pot roast stroganoff

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Leftover pot roast in a creamy mushroom and sour cream sauce over noodles.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 lb beef roast, cooked, shredded
- 2 cans cream of mushroom soup
- ¾ cup sour cream
- 1 onion
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook onion in butter 5 minutes; add soup, ½ cup water and beef; simmer 10 minutes.
2. Stir in sour cream; serve over cooked noodles. Great for leftover pot roast.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 684 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 752 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 513 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 342 cal

Per adult serving: 684 cal · 39 g protein · 50 g carbs · 36 g fat · 3 g fiber · 831 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $17.28 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.76 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pot roast with vegetables and gravy

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Fall-apart beef roast with potatoes, carrots and onions in a rich, savory gravy.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3¾ lb beef roast
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 2 onions, quartered
- 6 potatoes, chunks
- 6 carrots, chunks
- 2 cubes chicken bouillon *
- 3 Tbsp flour

Steps

1. Season roast; brown all sides in oil in a Dutch oven.
2. Add onions, 2 cups water and bouillon; cover and bake at 325°F for 2½ hours.
3. Add potatoes and carrots; bake 1 hour more.
4. Whisk flour into ½ cup cold water; stir into pan juices and simmer 3 minutes for gravy.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 616 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 677 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 462 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 308 cal

Per adult serving: 616 cal · 44 g protein · 37 g carbs · 32 g fat · 5 g fiber · 969 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $21.03 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $4.57 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ribbon noodle lasagna

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Layers of noodles, hearty meat sauce and creamy cheese, baked until bubbly.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 jars spaghetti sauce
- 2 cups cottage cheese
- 1 egg
- 2 cups shredded cheddar
- 2 tsp Italian seasoning *
- ½ tsp garlic powder *

Steps

1. Boil noodles 2 minutes short; drain. Brown beef; drain; add sauce and seasonings.
2. Mix cottage cheese with egg.
3. Layer in a 9x13 pan: sauce, noodles, cottage cheese, cheddar; repeat, ending with sauce and cheddar.
4. Cover; bake at 375°F for 30 minutes; uncover for 10. Rest 10 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 593 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 652 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 445 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 296 cal

Per adult serving: 593 cal · 33 g protein · 49 g carbs · 29 g fat · 6 g fiber · 1,159 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.42 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.27 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sausage, peppers and potatoes sheet-pan

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Browned sausage, sweet peppers and crispy potatoes roasted together on one pan.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb pork sausage
- 6 potatoes, chunks
- 2 bell peppers, strips
- 1 onion, wedges
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 1 tsp salt

Steps

1. Toss potatoes with oil, Italian seasoning and salt; roast at 425°F for 20 minutes.
2. Add peppers, onion and sausage in small patties or pieces; roast 20 minutes more, to 160°F.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 682 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 750 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 511 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 341 cal

Per adult serving: 682 cal · 22 g protein · 62 g carbs · 40 g fat · 8 g fiber · 1,298 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $11.99 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.61 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Scalloped potatoes and ham

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender sliced potatoes and ham baked in a creamy, cheesy sauce.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 potatoes, thin slices
- 1 lb sliced ham, diced
- ½ onion
- 4 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup flour
- 3 cups milk
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Melt butter; stir in flour, then milk, salt and pepper; simmer until thick; stir in half the cheese.
2. Layer potatoes, ham and onion in a 9x13 pan; pour sauce over.
3. Cover and bake at 375°F for 1 hour; uncover, add cheese, bake 15 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 468 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 515 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 351 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 234 cal

Per adult serving: 468 cal · 26 g protein · 50 g carbs · 19 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,431 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.11 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.76 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Shepherd's pie

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Savory beef and vegetables under a fluffy blanket of cheesy mashed potatoes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned fully cooked beef
- 1 onion, diced
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 Tbsp flour
- 1 cube chicken bouillon *
- 1 can corn
- 1 can green beans
- 3 cups instant potato flakes
- 1½ cups milk
- 3 Tbsp butter
- 1 cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Cook onion in oil 5 minutes; stir in flour, then beef with juices, bouillon and ½ cup water; simmer until thick.
2. Stir in drained corn and green beans; spread in a 9x13 pan.
3. Make potatoes with milk, butter and water per the box; spread on top; add cheese.
4. Bake at 375°F for 25 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 534 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 588 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 401 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 267 cal

Per adult serving: 534 cal · 39 g protein · 41 g carbs · 25 g fat · 5 g fiber · 1,121 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.81 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.35 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Shredded beef tacos

Dinner · Gluten-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Slow-roasted, juicy shredded beef in warm tortillas with fresh toppings.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3¾ lb beef roast
- 3 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1½ cups salsa
- 1 onion
- 24 corn tortillas
- ½ head lettuce
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 1 tsp salt

Steps

1. Rub roast with taco seasoning and salt; set on sliced onion with 1 cup salsa and 1 cup water; cover.
2. Bake at 300°F for 4 hours; shred in the juices.
3. Serve in warm tortillas with lettuce, cheese and the rest of the salsa.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 676 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 744 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 507 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 338 cal

Per adult serving: 676 cal · 49 g protein · 40 g carbs · 36 g fat · 6 g fiber · 1,136 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $22.16 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $4.82 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Spaghetti marinara with peppers

Dinner · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Spaghetti tossed in a rich marinara with sweet sautéed peppers and onions.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 oz spaghetti
- 2 jars spaghetti sauce
- 1 bell pepper, sliced
- ½ onion, diced
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- ½ tsp garlic powder *

Steps

1. Cook pepper and onion in oil 6 minutes; add sauce and seasonings; simmer 10 minutes.
2. Boil spaghetti 9–11 minutes; drain and toss with sauce.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 655 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 721 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 491 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 328 cal

Per adult serving: 655 cal · 20 g protein · 120 g carbs · 12 g fat · 14 g fiber · 1,452 mg sodium · 10 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.79 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.69 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Spaghetti with meat sauce and garlic toast

Dinner · Packs to go

Hearty meat sauce over spaghetti with crisp, buttery garlic toast.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 lb ground beef
- ½ onion, diced
- 2 jars spaghetti sauce
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning *
- 1 tsp garlic powder *
- 16 oz spaghetti
- 8 slices white bread
- 3 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Brown beef with onion; drain. Add sauce, Italian seasoning and half the garlic powder; simmer 15 minutes.
2. Boil spaghetti in salted water 9–11 minutes; drain.
3. Spread bread with butter mixed with the rest of the garlic powder; broil 2 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 1,133 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,246 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 850 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 566 cal

Per adult serving: 1,133 cal · 45 g protein · 147 g carbs · 41 g fat · 15 g fiber · 1,874 mg sodium · 14 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $14.92 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $3.24 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Swedish-style meatballs over noodles

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Savory meatballs in a creamy, velvety sauce over buttery egg noodles.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb ground beef
- 2 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- 1 egg
- ½ onion, minced
- 2 cans cream of mushroom soup
- ½ cup sour cream
- ½ cup milk
- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Mix beef, crumbs, egg, onion, salt and pepper; roll 30 meatballs; brown in butter.
2. Add soup, milk and ½ cup water; simmer 15 minutes; stir in sour cream.
3. Serve over cooked noodles.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 696 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 766 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 522 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 348 cal

Per adult serving: 696 cal · 33 g protein · 55 g carbs · 38 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,262 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $11.76 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.56 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sweet and sour chicken

Dinner · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Crispy chicken, peppers and peaches tossed in a bright sweet and sour sauce.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ lb chicken breasts, bite-size
- ½ cup flour
- 1 egg
- 4 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 bell pepper
- ½ onion
- 4 Tbsp ketchup
- ¼ cup sugar
- 3 Tbsp white vinegar *
- 2 Tbsp soy sauce *
- 1 can canned peaches, drained, diced
- 2 cups rice (uncooked)

Steps

1. Cook rice. Dip chicken in beaten egg, then flour; fry in oil until golden and 165°F.
2. Cook pepper and onion 3 minutes.
3. Simmer ketchup, sugar, vinegar, soy sauce and ¼ cup peach syrup 3 minutes; add peaches, chicken and vegetables.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 980 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 1,078 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 735 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 490 cal

Per adult serving: 980 cal · 50 g protein · 145 g carbs · 20 g fat · 4 g fiber · 760 mg sodium · 29 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $13.67 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.97 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Three-bean vegan chili with rice

Dinner · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

A thick, smoky three-bean chili over rice, packed with peppers and tomatoes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans black beans
- 2 cans pinto beans
- 1 can great northern beans
- 1 can diced tomatoes (28 oz)
- 1 can tomato sauce
- 1 onion, diced
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- 3 Tbsp taco seasoning *
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 cups rice (uncooked)

Steps

1. Cook onion and pepper in oil 5 minutes.
2. Add drained beans, tomatoes, sauce, seasoning and 1 cup water; simmer 30 minutes.
3. Serve over cooked rice.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 647 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 711 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 485 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 323 cal

Per adult serving: 647 cal · 26 g protein · 125 g carbs · 4 g fat · 25 g fiber · 2,138 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.48 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.63 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tofu and vegetable stir-fry

Dinner · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Golden tofu and crisp vegetables tossed in a sweet, savory soy glaze over rice.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 block firm tofu, cubed, pressed dry *
- 2 cups rice (uncooked)
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 4 cups broccoli florets
- 1 bell pepper
- 2 carrots
- 1 onion
- 5 Tbsp soy sauce *
- 2 Tbsp pancake syrup
- ½ tsp garlic powder *

Steps

1. Cook rice.
2. Brown tofu in 2 Tbsp oil 8 minutes; remove.
3. Stir-fry vegetables in remaining oil 4 minutes.
4. Add soy sauce, syrup, garlic and ¼ cup water with the tofu; simmer 2 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 621 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 683 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 466 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 311 cal

Per adult serving: 621 cal · 21 g protein · 98 g carbs · 16 g fat · 6 g fiber · 1,202 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $9.59 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.08 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tuna noodle casserole with salad

Dinner · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy, cheesy tuna and noodles baked until bubbly, with a crisp side salad.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 12 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- 2 cans cream of mushroom soup
- 1 can evaporated milk
- 3 cans tuna, drained
- 1 can corn, drained
- 1½ cups shredded cheddar
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ head lettuce
- ½ cucumber
- 1 tomato
- 4 Tbsp ranch dressing

Steps

1. Boil noodles 2 minutes less than the package says; drain.
2. Stir in soup, evaporated milk, tuna, corn, pepper and 1 cup cheese.
3. Spread in a 9x13 pan; top with the rest of the cheese; bake at 375°F for 25 minutes.
4. Toss salad with ranch.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 658 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 724 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 493 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 329 cal

Per adult serving: 658 cal · 36 g protein · 65 g carbs · 28 g fat · 4 g fiber · 1,341 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $10.77 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $2.34 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Tuna patties with mac and cheese

Dinner · Lower-sugar pick

Golden, crispy tuna patties served with creamy mac and cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cans tuna, drained
- 2 eggs
- 3 slices white bread, made into crumbs
- ¼ onion, minced
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 boxes macaroni and cheese
- ½ cup milk
- 4 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Mix tuna, eggs, crumbs and onion; shape 8 patties.
2. Fry in oil 3–4 minutes per side.
3. Make mac and cheese per the box.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 772 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 849 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 579 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 386 cal

Per adult serving: 772 cal · 45 g protein · 78 g carbs · 31 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1,505 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $8.63 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.88 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Vegetable and tofu fried rice

Dinner · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy tofu and vegetables stir-fried with rice and a splash of soy sauce.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups rice (uncooked), cooked a day ahead
- 3 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 block firm tofu, cubed *
- 2 carrots
- 1 onion
- 1 can corn
- 2 cups broccoli florets
- 4 Tbsp soy sauce *

Steps

1. Brown tofu in 2 Tbsp oil; remove.
2. Stir-fry vegetables in the rest of the oil 5 minutes.
3. Add cold rice; stir-fry 5 minutes; stir in tofu and soy sauce.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 621 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 683 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 466 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 311 cal

Per adult serving: 621 cal · 21 g protein · 98 g carbs · 17 g fat · 6 g fiber · 1,127 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $7.32 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.59 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Side dishes

Baked potatoes

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Fluffy baked potatoes with butter and a dollop of sour cream.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 potatoes
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup sour cream
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Bake scrubbed, pricked potatoes at 400°F for 1 hour (or microwave 10–12 minutes).
2. Split; top with butter and sour cream.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 239 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 263 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 179 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 119 cal

Per adult serving: 239 cal · 5 g protein · 38 g carbs · 9 g fat · 4 g fiber · 137 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.70 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.59 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Baking powder biscuits

Side dish · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Flaky, buttery homemade biscuits, golden and tall.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 6 Tbsp butter
- ¾ cup milk

Steps

1. Mix flour, baking powder and salt; cut in butter; stir in milk.
2. Pat ¾ inch thick; cut 10 rounds; bake at 450°F for 10–12 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 202 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 223 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 152 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 101 cal

Per adult serving: 202 cal · 4 g protein · 25 g carbs · 9 g fat · 1 g fiber · 550 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.81 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.18 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Buttered corn

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Sweet, buttery corn with a crack of black pepper.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans corn
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Heat corn; drain; stir in butter and pepper.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 131 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 144 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 98 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 65 cal

Per adult serving: 131 cal · 4 g protein · 23 g carbs · 4 g fat · 4 g fiber · 373 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.96 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.43 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Buttered green beans

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender green beans tossed with melted butter, salt and pepper.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans green beans
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1/8 tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Heat green beans with their liquid; drain.
2. Toss with butter, salt and pepper.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 61 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 67 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 46 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 30 cal

Per adult serving: 61 cal · 2 g protein · 7 g carbs · 3 g fat · 4 g fiber · 594 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.96 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.43 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Buttered noodles

Side dish · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Soft egg noodles tossed with butter, salt and pepper.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 oz ribbon pasta (egg noodles)
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Cook noodles; drain; toss with butter, salt and pepper.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 216 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 238 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 162 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 108 cal

Per adult serving: 216 cal · 6 g protein · 30 g carbs · 8 g fat · 2 g fiber · 196 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.40 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.30 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cheesy broccoli

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Tender broccoli smothered in melted cheddar.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cups broccoli florets
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Steam broccoli; top with cheese until melted.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 79 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 87 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 60 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 40 cal

Per adult serving: 79 cal · 5 g protein · 5 g carbs · 5 g fat · 2 g fiber · 110 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.93 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.64 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chilled peaches

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Sweet, juicy peaches served chilled.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ½ can canned peaches

Steps

1. Serve drained peaches cold.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 75 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 83 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 56 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 38 cal

Per adult serving: 75 cal · 1 g protein · 19 g carbs · 0 g fat · 1 g fiber · 6 mg sodium · 6 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.43 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.31 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cinnamon applesauce

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Smooth applesauce with a sprinkle of cinnamon.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups applesauce
- ¼ tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Spoon applesauce into bowls; sprinkle with cinnamon.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 85 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 94 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 64 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 43 cal

Per adult serving: 85 cal · 0 g protein · 21 g carbs · 0 g fat · 2 g fiber · 3 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.68 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cottage cheese with pepper

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Cool, creamy cottage cheese with a crack of pepper.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cup cottage cheese
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Serve ¼ cup per person with a little pepper.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 55 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 61 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 41 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 28 cal

Per adult serving: 55 cal · 6 g protein · 2 g carbs · 3 g fat · 0 g fiber · 205 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.72 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cucumber-tomato salad

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Cool cucumbers and juicy tomatoes in a tangy, simple dressing.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cucumber, sliced
- 2 tomatoes, chopped
- ¼ onion, thin slices
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 Tbsp white vinegar *
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Toss vegetables with oil, vinegar, salt and pepper.
2. Chill 20 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 56 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 62 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 42 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 28 cal

Per adult serving: 56 cal · 1 g protein · 6 g carbs · 4 g fat · 1 g fiber · 149 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.84 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.62 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Doctored pork and beans

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go

Sweet, tangy pork and beans baked with ketchup, brown sugar and onion.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 can pork and beans
- 2 Tbsp ketchup
- 3 tsp brown sugar
- 1½ tsp mustard
- ¼ onion, minced

Steps

1. Stir everything together in a small dish.
2. Bake at 350°F for 30 minutes, or simmer 10 minutes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 149 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 164 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 112 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 74 cal

Per adult serving: 149 cal · 5 g protein · 31 g carbs · 1 g fat · 5 g fiber · 522 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.40 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.30 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Garden salad with oil and vinegar

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A fresh, crunchy salad with a light herb oil and vinegar dressing.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ½ head lettuce
- 1 tomato
- ½ cucumber
- ½ bell pepper
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 Tbsp white vinegar *
- 1/8 tsp salt
- ¼ tsp Italian seasoning *

Steps

1. Chop vegetables; toss.
2. Whisk oil, vinegar, salt and Italian seasoning; pour over just before serving.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 85 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 94 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 64 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 43 cal

Per adult serving: 85 cal · 1 g protein · 6 g carbs · 7 g fat · 2 g fiber · 82 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.40 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.74 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Garlic green beans (vegan)

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Green beans sautéed in oil with fragrant garlic.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans green beans
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp garlic powder *
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Drain beans; sauté in oil with garlic powder 4 minutes; salt.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 66 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 73 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 50 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 33 cal

Per adult serving: 66 cal · 2 g protein · 7 g carbs · 4 g fat · 4 g fiber · 572 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.89 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.41 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Garlic oil pasta (vegan)

Side dish · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Spaghetti tossed in garlicky herb oil.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 oz spaghetti
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp garlic powder *
- ¼ tsp Italian seasoning *
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Cook spaghetti; drain; toss with oil, garlic powder and Italian seasoning.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 211 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 233 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 159 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 106 cal

Per adult serving: 211 cal · 5 g protein · 32 g carbs · 8 g fat · 2 g fiber · 144 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.77 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.17 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Garlic toast

Side dish · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crisp, buttery toast with savory garlic.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 slices white bread
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ¼ tsp garlic powder *

Steps

1. Spread bread with butter mixed with garlic powder; broil 2 minutes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 127 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 139 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 95 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 63 cal

Per adult serving: 127 cal · 3 g protein · 14 g carbs · 7 g fat · 1 g fiber · 185 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.72 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.16 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Honey-glazed carrots

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Sweet, buttery carrots glazed with honey.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 5 carrots, sliced
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1 Tbsp honey
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer carrots in ½ cup water until tender, 8 minutes; drain.
2. Stir in butter, honey and salt.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 73 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 80 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 55 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 36 cal

Per adult serving: 73 cal · 1 g protein · 12 g carbs · 3 g fat · 2 g fiber · 147 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.40 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.30 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Mac and cheese side

Side dish · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

A small bowl of creamy, cheesy mac and cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box macaroni and cheese
- ¼ cup milk
- 2 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Make mac and cheese per the box.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 234 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 257 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 175 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 117 cal

Per adult serving: 234 cal · 7 g protein · 33 g carbs · 8 g fat · 1 g fiber · 502 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.29 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.28 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Mashed potatoes

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Fluffy, buttery homemade mashed potatoes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 potatoes
- 3 Tbsp butter
- ½ cup milk
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Boil peeled, cubed potatoes 15 minutes until tender; drain.
2. Mash with butter, milk and salt.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 252 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 277 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 189 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 126 cal

Per adult serving: 252 cal · 5 g protein · 39 g carbs · 9 g fat · 4 g fiber · 382 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.68 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.58 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Mixed fruit cup

Side dish, Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

A sweet mix of peaches, pears and juicy grapes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ½ can canned peaches
- ½ can canned pears
- 1 cup grapes

Steps

1. Dice drained peaches and pears; toss with grapes.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 176 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 194 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 132 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 88 cal

Per adult serving: 176 cal · 1 g protein · 44 g carbs · 0 g fat · 3 g fiber · 13 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.81 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.83 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pear halves

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Tender, sweet pear halves served cold.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ½ can canned pears

Steps

1. Serve drained pears cold.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 75 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 83 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 56 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 38 cal

Per adult serving: 75 cal · 0 g protein · 19 g carbs · 0 g fat · 1 g fiber · 6 mg sodium · 6 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.43 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.31 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Quick instant mashed potatoes

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy, buttery mashed potatoes ready in five minutes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1¼ cups instant potato flakes
- 5/8 cup milk
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Heat 11/3 cups water with milk, butter and salt to a boil; remove from heat.
2. Stir in flakes; let stand 1 minute; fluff.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 141 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 155 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 106 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 71 cal

Per adult serving: 141 cal · 3 g protein · 18 g carbs · 7 g fat · 1 g fiber · 228 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.97 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.21 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ranch salad with carrots

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crisp lettuce, shredded carrots and cucumber with creamy ranch.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ½ head lettuce, chopped
- 2 carrots, shredded
- ½ cucumber, sliced
- 4 Tbsp ranch dressing

Steps

1. Toss lettuce, carrots and cucumber.
2. Serve with ranch.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 98 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 107 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 73 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 49 cal

Per adult serving: 98 cal · 1 g protein · 7 g carbs · 7 g fat · 2 g fiber · 159 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.32 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.50 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Raw veggies with ranch

Side dish, Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crunchy carrots, cucumbers and peppers with cool ranch dip.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 carrots
- 1 cucumber
- 1 bell pepper
- 4 Tbsp ranch dressing

Steps

1. Cut vegetables into sticks; serve with ranch.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 108 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 118 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 81 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 54 cal

Per adult serving: 108 cal · 1 g protein · 10 g carbs · 7 g fat · 2 g fiber · 164 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.35 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.73 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Refried beans with cheese

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy refried beans topped with melted cheddar.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ¾ cup dehydrated refried bean flakes
- ¼ cup shredded cheddar
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Stir flakes into 1 cup boiling water; cover 5 minutes; stir smooth.
2. Top with cheese.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 111 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 122 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 83 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 55 cal

Per adult serving: 111 cal · 6 g protein · 14 g carbs · 3 g fat · 5 g fiber · 378 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.13 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.25 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Roasted carrots (vegan)

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Caramelized roasted carrots with a hint of cinnamon.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 5 carrots
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¼ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Toss carrots with oil, salt and cinnamon.
2. Roast at 425°F for 25 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 62 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 68 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 46 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 31 cal

Per adult serving: 62 cal · 1 g protein · 8 g carbs · 4 g fat · 2 g fiber · 196 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.03 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.22 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Roasted potatoes

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Golden, crispy garlic roasted potatoes, tender inside.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 potatoes, cubed
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp salt
- ½ tsp garlic powder *
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Toss potatoes with oil and seasonings.
2. Roast at 425°F for 30–35 minutes, turning once.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 221 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 244 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 166 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 111 cal

Per adult serving: 221 cal · 4 g protein · 37 g carbs · 7 g fat · 4 g fiber · 301 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.24 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.49 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Salsa rice

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Toasty rice simmered with zesty salsa.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cup rice (uncooked)
- ½ cup salsa
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Toast rice in oil 2 minutes.
2. Add salsa, 1½ cups water and salt; cover and simmer 18 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 210 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 231 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 158 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 105 cal

Per adult serving: 210 cal · 4 g protein · 39 g carbs · 4 g fat · 1 g fiber · 371 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.10 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.24 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sautéed peppers and onions

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Sweet peppers and onions sautéed until soft and golden.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 bell peppers, strips
- 1 onion, strips
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¼ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp Italian seasoning *

Steps

1. Cook in oil over medium-high heat 8 minutes until soft and browned. Season.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 56 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 62 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 42 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 28 cal

Per adult serving: 56 cal · 1 g protein · 6 g carbs · 4 g fat · 2 g fiber · 147 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.56 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.77 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Seasoned black beans

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Savory black beans simmered with onion and taco spices.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 can black beans
- ¼ onion, minced
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1½ tsp taco seasoning *

Steps

1. Cook onion in oil 3 minutes; add beans with liquid and seasoning; simmer 8 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 132 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 145 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 99 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 66 cal

Per adult serving: 132 cal · 6 g protein · 19 g carbs · 4 g fat · 7 g fiber · 438 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.22 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.27 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Simple pinto beans

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Tender, savory pinto beans with onion and garlic.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 can pinto beans
- ¼ onion
- ¼ tsp garlic powder *
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer beans with liquid, onion and seasonings 10 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 100 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 110 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 75 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 50 cal

Per adult serving: 100 cal · 5 g protein · 18 g carbs · 1 g fat · 5 g fiber · 422 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.02 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.22 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Sliced tomatoes

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy tomato slices with a sprinkle of salt and pepper.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 tomatoes
- 1/8 tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Slice; sprinkle with salt and pepper.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 11 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 12 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 8 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 6 cal

Per adult serving: 11 cal · 1 g protein · 3 g carbs · 0 g fat · 1 g fiber · 75 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.73 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.38 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Steamed broccoli

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Bright, tender steamed broccoli with a pat of butter.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3 cups broccoli florets
- 1 Tbsp butter
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Steam broccoli 4–5 minutes until bright green; toss with butter and salt.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 48 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 53 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 36 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 24 cal

Per adult serving: 48 cal · 2 g protein · 5 g carbs · 3 g fat · 2 g fiber · 117 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.30 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.50 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Steamed rice

Side dish · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Fluffy, buttery steamed rice.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cup rice (uncooked)
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Bring 2 cups water, salt and butter to a boil; add rice.
2. Cover; simmer 18 minutes; rest 5 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 197 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 216 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 148 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 98 cal

Per adult serving: 197 cal · 3 g protein · 38 g carbs · 3 g fat · 1 g fiber · 169 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.72 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.16 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Strawberry fruit gelatin salad

Side dish, Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Cool, sweet strawberry gelatin with peaches and bananas.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box strawberry gelatin
- ½ can canned peaches, diced
- 1 banana, sliced

Steps

1. Make gelatin per the box; chill until syrupy, about 1 hour.
2. Stir in fruit; chill until set.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 131 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 144 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 98 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 65 cal

Per adult serving: 131 cal · 2 g protein · 32 g carbs · 0 g fat · 1 g fiber · 103 mg sodium · 22 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.71 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Warm corn tortillas

Side dish · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Soft, warm corn tortillas for wrapping or dipping.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 corn tortillas

Steps

1. Warm in a dry skillet 30 seconds per side; keep wrapped in a towel.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 110 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 121 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 83 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 55 cal

Per adult serving: 110 cal · 3 g protein · 22 g carbs · 2 g fat · 3 g fiber · 20 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.76 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.17 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Yeast dinner rolls

Side dish · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Soft, fluffy homemade rolls brushed with butter, warm from the oven.

Makes 16 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 pack yeast
- 1 cup milk
- ¼ cup sugar
- 5 Tbsp butter
- 1 egg
- 1 tsp salt
- 4 cups flour

Steps

1. Dissolve yeast in ¼ cup warm water; mix in warm milk, sugar, 4 Tbsp melted butter, egg and salt; add flour; knead 6 minutes.
2. Rise 1 hour; shape 16 balls in a greased 9x13 pan; rise 30 minutes.
3. Bake at 375°F for 15–18 minutes; brush with butter.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 171 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 188 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 128 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 86 cal

Per adult serving: 171 cal · 4 g protein · 28 g carbs · 4 g fat · 1 g fiber · 184 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.67 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.15 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Snacks

Apple slices with peanut butter

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crisp apple slices with creamy peanut butter for dipping.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 apples
- 4 Tbsp peanut butter

Steps

1. Slice apples; pack with peanut butter for dipping.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 143 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 157 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 107 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 71 cal

Per adult serving: 143 cal · 4 g protein · 16 g carbs · 8 g fat · 3 g fiber · 71 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.59 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.34 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Applesauce cup

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Smooth, sweet applesauce with an optional dash of cinnamon.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups applesauce

Steps

1. Spoon ½ cup into small containers; sprinkle with cinnamon if you like.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 85 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 94 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 64 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 43 cal

Per adult serving: 85 cal · 0 g protein · 21 g carbs · 0 g fat · 2 g fiber · 3 mg sodium · 4 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.67 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.36 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Baked tortilla chips and salsa

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Crisp, salty baked tortilla chips with zesty salsa.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 corn tortillas
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1 cup salsa

Steps

1. Brush tortillas lightly with oil; cut in 6 wedges; sprinkle with salt.
2. Bake at 375°F for 10–12 minutes, until crisp. Serve with salsa.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 158 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 173 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 118 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 79 cal

Per adult serving: 158 cal · 4 g protein · 26 g carbs · 6 g fat · 4 g fiber · 614 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.78 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.39 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Banana

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A sweet, ripe banana, nature's grab-and-go snack.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 bananas

Steps

1. One banana per person.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 105 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 116 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 79 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 53 cal

Per adult serving: 105 cal · 1 g protein · 27 g carbs · 0 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.19 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.26 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Brownie mix cookies

Dessert, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Fudgy, chewy cookies made from brownie mix.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box brownie mix
- 2 eggs
- 4 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Stir mix, eggs and oil into a thick dough.
2. Drop 24 spoonfuls on a lined sheet; bake at 350°F for 9 minutes.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 219 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 241 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 164 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 109 cal

Per adult serving: 219 cal · 3 g protein · 33 g carbs · 9 g fat · 1 g fiber · 153 mg sodium · 22 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.01 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.22 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Carrot sticks with ranch

Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crunchy carrot sticks with cool ranch dip.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 carrots
- 4 Tbsp ranch dressing

Steps

1. Cut carrots into sticks; pack with ranch.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 95 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 105 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 71 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 48 cal

Per adult serving: 95 cal · 1 g protein · 7 g carbs · 7 g fat · 2 g fiber · 172 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.12 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.24 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cereal and raisin snack mix

Snack · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A crunchy, sweet mix of honey nut o's and chewy raisins.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups honey nut o's
- ½ cup raisins

Steps

1. Toss cereal and raisins; pack in bags.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 131 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 144 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 98 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 66 cal

Per adult serving: 131 cal · 2 g protein · 31 g carbs · 1 g fat · 2 g fiber · 97 mg sodium · 5 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.96 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.21 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cheesy garlic toast

Snack · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Crunchy, buttery garlic toast topped with melted cheddar.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 slices white bread
- 3 Tbsp butter
- ½ tsp garlic powder *
- ½ cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Spread bread with butter mixed with garlic powder; top with cheese.
2. Broil 2–3 minutes until golden.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 210 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 231 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 157 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 105 cal

Per adult serving: 210 cal · 6 g protein · 14 g carbs · 14 g fat · 1 g fiber · 295 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.68 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.36 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cinnamon-sugar biscuit bites

Snack, Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Warm, fluffy biscuit bites rolled in buttery cinnamon sugar.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 3 tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp salt
- 8 Tbsp butter
- ¾ cup milk
- ¼ cup sugar
- 2 tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Make biscuit dough with flour, baking powder, salt, 6 Tbsp butter and milk; cut into 32 pieces.
2. Roll in 2 Tbsp melted butter, then cinnamon sugar.
3. Bake on a sheet at 400°F for 12 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 254 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 279 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 190 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 127 cal

Per adult serving: 254 cal · 4 g protein · 32 g carbs · 12 g fat · 1 g fiber · 429 mg sodium · 6 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.08 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.23 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cinnamon-sugar tortilla crisps

Snack, Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Crunchy tortilla wedges baked with butter and cinnamon sugar.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 flour tortillas
- 2 Tbsp butter, melted
- 2 Tbsp sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Brush tortillas with butter; sprinkle with cinnamon sugar; cut in wedges.
2. Bake at 375°F for 8–10 minutes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 217 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 238 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 163 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 108 cal

Per adult serving: 217 cal · 4 g protein · 31 g carbs · 9 g fat · 1 g fiber · 395 mg sodium · 6 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.38 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.30 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Classic peanut butter cookies

Dessert, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Classic soft and chewy peanut butter cookies with a crisscross top.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 Tbsp butter
- 8 Tbsp peanut butter
- ½ cup sugar
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 1 egg
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1½ cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Beat butter, peanut butter and sugars; beat in egg and vanilla.
2. Stir in flour, baking soda and salt; roll 24 balls; press with a fork.
3. Bake at 375°F for 9–10 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 262 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 288 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 197 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 131 cal

Per adult serving: 262 cal · 5 g protein · 31 g carbs · 14 g fat · 1 g fiber · 316 mg sodium · 18 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.05 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.23 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Creamy hot cocoa

Snack, Dessert · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Extra-creamy hot cocoa made with milk instead of water.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 servings hot cocoa mix
- 2 cups non-fat dry milk (mixed)

Steps

1. Mix hot cocoa with prepared dry milk instead of water; heat until steaming.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 150 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 165 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 113 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 75 cal

Per adult serving: 150 cal · 5 g protein · 28 g carbs · 2 g fat · 1 g fiber · 213 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.38 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.30 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cucumber spears with ranch

Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Cool, crisp cucumber spears with creamy ranch.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cucumber
- 4 Tbsp ranch dressing

Steps

1. Cut cucumber into spears; pack with ranch.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 81 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 89 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 61 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 41 cal

Per adult serving: 81 cal · 1 g protein · 4 g carbs · 7 g fat · 1 g fiber · 132 mg sodium · 1 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.25 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.27 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free oatmeal raisin cookies

Dessert, Snack · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Chewy oatmeal raisin cookies made with oil instead of butter.

Makes 18 adult servings

Ingredients

- 10 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 cup brown sugar
- ½ cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1¾ cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ½ tsp salt
- 3 cups rolled oats
- 1 cup raisins

Steps

1. Whisk oil, sugars, eggs and vanilla.
2. Stir in flour, baking soda, cinnamon and salt, then oats and raisins.
3. Drop by tablespoons; bake at 350°F for 10–12 minutes. Makes 36.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 265 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 291 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 199 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 132 cal

Per adult serving: 265 cal · 4 g protein · 43 g carbs · 9 g fat · 2 g fiber · 147 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.11 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.24 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Fresh fruit salad

Snack, Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A colorful mix of crisp apple, banana, juicy orange and grapes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 apple, diced
- 2 bananas, sliced
- 2 oranges, segmented
- 1 cup grapes

Steps

1. Toss all the fruit; the orange juice keeps the apples from browning.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 89 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 98 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 67 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 44 cal

Per adult serving: 89 cal · 1 g protein · 23 g carbs · 0 g fat · 3 g fiber · 1 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.37 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.52 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Glazed sugar cookies

Dessert, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Tender, buttery sugar cookies finished with a sweet vanilla glaze.

Makes 18 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 Tbsp butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 1 egg
- 1½ tsp vanilla
- 2¾ cups flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp salt
- 1½ cups powdered sugar
- 3 Tbsp milk

Steps

1. Beat butter and sugar; beat in egg and 1 tsp vanilla; stir in flour, baking powder and salt.
2. Roll balls and flatten, or roll and cut shapes; bake at 375°F for 8–9 minutes.
3. Glaze with powdered sugar, milk and the rest of the vanilla.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 249 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 274 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 187 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 124 cal

Per adult serving: 249 cal · 3 g protein · 36 g carbs · 11 g fat · 0 g fiber · 177 mg sodium · 21 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.02 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.22 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Gluten-free energy bites

Snack, Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Chewy, peanut buttery oat bites sweetened with honey, made gluten-free.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cup certified gluten-free oats *
- 8 Tbsp peanut butter
- 5 Tbsp honey
- ½ cup raisins
- ½ tsp cinnamon
- ½ tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Mix everything in a bowl.
2. Chill 20 minutes; roll into 18 balls. Serving = 3 bites.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 272 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 300 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 204 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 136 cal

Per adult serving: 272 cal · 7 g protein · 38 g carbs · 12 g fat · 3 g fiber · 97 mg sodium · 16 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.32 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.50 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Grapes

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A handful of juicy, refreshing grapes.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups grapes

Steps

1. Wash; pack ½ cup per person.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 52 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 57 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 39 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 26 cal

Per adult serving: 52 cal · 1 g protein · 14 g carbs · 0 g fat · 1 g fiber · 2 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.91 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.42 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Grapes with honey yogurt dip

Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Juicy grapes with a creamy honey yogurt dip.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups grapes
- 1 cup vanilla yogurt
- 1 Tbsp honey

Steps

1. Stir honey into yogurt; serve as a dip for grapes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 121 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 133 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 90 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 60 cal

Per adult serving: 121 cal · 3 g protein · 26 g carbs · 1 g fat · 1 g fiber · 39 mg sodium · 8 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.51 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.76 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Ham and cheese roll-ups (no bread)

Snack · Gluten-free · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Savory ham rolled around cheddar sticks, no bread needed.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ¼ lb sliced ham
- ½ cup shredded cheddar, in sticks

Steps

1. Roll ham slices around cheese sticks.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 87 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 96 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 65 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 43 cal

Per adult serving: 87 cal · 8 g protein · 1 g carbs · 6 g fat · 0 g fiber · 388 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.22 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.48 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hard-boiled eggs

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Simple, protein-packed hard-boiled eggs with a pinch of salt and pepper.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 eggs
- 1/8 tsp salt
- 1/8 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Boil eggs 11 minutes; cool in cold water.
2. Keep in the fridge up to a week.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 72 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 79 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 54 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 36 cal

Per adult serving: 72 cal · 6 g protein · 0 g carbs · 5 g fat · 0 g fiber · 142 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.96 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.21 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Honey nut cereal bars

Snack · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Chewy honey nut cereal bars held together with peanut butter and honey.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cups honey nut o's
- 8 Tbsp peanut butter
- 8 Tbsp honey
- ¼ cup brown sugar

Steps

1. Warm peanut butter, honey and brown sugar until smooth.
2. Stir in cereal; press into an 8x8 pan; chill and cut 12 bars.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 170 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 187 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 127 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 85 cal

Per adult serving: 170 cal · 4 g protein · 28 g carbs · 6 g fat · 2 g fiber · 112 mg sodium · 20 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.26 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.27 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Honey-butter cereal snack mix

Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Crunchy cereal toasted in honey butter and cinnamon, tossed with raisins.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cups honey nut o's
- 3 Tbsp butter
- 2 Tbsp honey
- ½ tsp cinnamon
- ½ cup raisins

Steps

1. Melt butter with honey and cinnamon; toss with cereal.
2. Bake on a sheet at 300°F for 15 minutes, stirring once; cool and add raisins.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 207 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 228 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 155 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 104 cal

Per adult serving: 207 cal · 2 g protein · 37 g carbs · 7 g fat · 3 g fiber · 174 mg sodium · 12 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.58 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.34 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Hot cocoa

Snack, Dessert · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A warm, comforting mug of rich hot cocoa.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 servings hot cocoa mix

Steps

1. Stir each packet or serving into 1 cup hot water.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 110 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 121 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 83 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 55 cal

Per adult serving: 110 cal · 1 g protein · 22 g carbs · 2 g fat · 1 g fiber · 150 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.62 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.13 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

No-bake energy bites

Snack, Dessert · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Chewy no-bake bites of oats, peanut butter, honey and raisins.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 8 Tbsp peanut butter
- 5 Tbsp honey
- ½ cup raisins
- ½ tsp cinnamon
- ½ tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Mix everything in a bowl.
2. Chill 20 minutes; roll into 18 balls. Keeps a week in the fridge. Serving = 3 bites.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 272 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 300 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 204 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 136 cal

Per adult serving: 272 cal · 7 g protein · 38 g carbs · 12 g fat · 3 g fiber · 97 mg sodium · 16 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.11 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.46 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Oatmeal raisin cookies

Dessert, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Chewy, golden oatmeal cookies packed with raisins and warm cinnamon.

Makes 18 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 Tbsp butter, softened
- 1 cup brown sugar
- ½ cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1½ cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ½ tsp salt
- 3 cups rolled oats
- 1 cup raisins

Steps

1. Beat butter and sugars; beat in eggs and vanilla.
2. Stir in flour, baking soda, cinnamon and salt, then oats and raisins.
3. Drop by tablespoons; bake at 350°F for 10–12 minutes. Makes 36.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.
To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 282 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 311 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 212 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 141 cal

Per adult serving: 282 cal · 4 g protein · 42 g carbs · 12 g fat · 2 g fiber · 227 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.51 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.33 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Orange

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A bright, juicy orange, peeled or cut into sunny wedges.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 oranges

Steps

1. One orange per person; peel or cut in wedges.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 62 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 68 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 47 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 31 cal

Per adult serving: 62 cal · 1 g protein · 15 g carbs · 0 g fat · 3 g fiber · 0 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.75 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.60 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Peaches and cottage cheese

Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Creamy cottage cheese topped with sweet, juicy peaches.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 cup cottage cheese
- 1 can canned peaches

Steps

1. Top cottage cheese with drained peaches.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 205 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 226 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 154 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 103 cal

Per adult serving: 205 cal · 7 g protein · 40 g carbs · 3 g fat · 2 g fiber · 218 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.57 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.99 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Peanut butter toast

Snack · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Warm toast with a thick spread of creamy peanut butter.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 slices whole wheat bread
- 4 Tbsp peanut butter

Steps

1. Toast bread; spread with peanut butter; cut in half.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 175 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 193 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 131 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 88 cal

Per adult serving: 175 cal · 8 g protein · 17 g carbs · 9 g fat · 3 g fiber · 210 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.90 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.19 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pear cups

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Tender, sweet pear slices, chilled and ready to eat.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 can canned pears

Steps

1. Divide drained pears into containers.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 150 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 165 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 113 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 75 cal

Per adult serving: 150 cal · 1 g protein · 38 g carbs · 0 g fat · 3 g fiber · 13 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.85 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.62 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pizza toast

Snack · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Crispy toast topped with pizza sauce and bubbly melted cheese.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 slices white bread
- ¼ jar spaghetti sauce
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- ¼ tsp Italian seasoning *

Steps

1. Spread bread with sauce; sprinkle seasoning and cheese.
2. Broil or toast 3–4 minutes until bubbly.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 158 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 174 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 119 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 79 cal

Per adult serving: 158 cal · 7 g protein · 18 g carbs · 6 g fat · 2 g fiber · 409 mg sodium · 3 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.73 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.38 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Raspberry oat bars

Dessert, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Buttery oat crumble bars with a sweet raspberry jam center.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups flour
- 1½ cups rolled oats
- ¾ cup brown sugar
- ½ tsp baking soda
- ¼ tsp salt
- 12 Tbsp butter
- 16 Tbsp raspberry jam

Steps

1. Mix flour, oats, brown sugar, baking soda and salt; stir in melted butter.
2. Press two-thirds into an 8x8 pan; spread with jam; crumble the rest on top.
3. Bake at 350°F for 35 minutes; cool before cutting.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 315 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 346 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 236 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 157 cal

Per adult serving: 315 cal · 3 g protein · 49 g carbs · 12 g fat · 1 g fiber · 202 mg sodium · 27 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.59 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.35 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Snickerdoodles

Dessert, Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Soft, chewy cookies rolled in sparkling cinnamon sugar.

Makes 18 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 Tbsp butter
- 1¾ cups sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 2¾ cups flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- ½ tsp salt
- 2 tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Beat butter and 1½ cups sugar; beat in eggs and vanilla; stir in flour, baking powder and salt.
2. Roll 1-inch balls in the rest of the sugar mixed with cinnamon.
3. Bake at 375°F for 9–10 minutes. Makes 36.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 245 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 269 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 184 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 122 cal

Per adult serving: 245 cal · 3 g protein · 34 g carbs · 11 g fat · 1 g fiber · 207 mg sodium · 19 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.03 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.22 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Soft pretzels

Snack · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Soft, chewy, golden pretzels with a sprinkle of salt and mustard for dipping.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 cups flour
- 1 pack yeast
- 3 tsp sugar
- 1½ tsp salt
- 32 tsp baking soda
- 2 Tbsp butter
- 4 Tbsp mustard

Steps

1. Dissolve yeast and sugar in 1½ cups warm water; add flour and 1 tsp salt; knead 5 minutes; rest 10 minutes.
2. Roll 8 ropes; twist into pretzels. Boil each 30 seconds in 10 cups water with the baking soda.
3. Bake at 425°F for 12–14 minutes; brush with butter; sprinkle with salt. Serve with mustard.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 266 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 293 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 200 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 133 cal

Per adult serving: 266 cal · 7 g protein · 50 g carbs · 4 g fat · 2 g fiber · 5,581 mg sodium · 2 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.15 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.25 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Stovetop popcorn

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Fresh, fluffy stovetop popcorn with just the right amount of salt.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 3/8 cup popcorn kernels *
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp salt

Steps

1. Heat oil with 3 kernels in a covered pot; when they pop, add the rest.
2. Shake the pot over medium-high heat until popping slows. Salt.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 119 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 131 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 90 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 60 cal

Per adult serving: 119 cal · 2 g protein · 12 g carbs · 8 g fat · 2 g fiber · 288 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.33 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.07 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Vanilla pudding fruit cups

Dessert, Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy vanilla pudding cups topped with peaches and grapes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box vanilla pudding mix
- 2 cups milk
- ½ can canned peaches
- 1 cup grapes

Steps

1. Make pudding with cold milk; spoon into cups.
2. Top with diced peaches and halved grapes.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 198 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 218 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 149 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 99 cal

Per adult serving: 198 cal · 3 g protein · 43 g carbs · 2 g fat · 1 g fiber · 443 mg sodium · 23 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.08 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.67 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Vanilla yogurt with granola crunch

Snack · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Smooth vanilla yogurt topped with crunchy honey-toasted oats.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups vanilla yogurt
- ½ cup rolled oats
- 1 Tbsp honey

Steps

1. Toast oats with honey 10 minutes at 325°F; cool.
2. Top ½ cup yogurt per person with oats.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 159 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 174 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 119 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 79 cal

Per adult serving: 159 cal · 6 g protein · 28 g carbs · 2 g fat · 1 g fiber · 76 mg sodium · 12 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.10 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.67 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Warm bean dip with chips

Snack · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Warm, cheesy bean dip with crunchy baked tortilla chips.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ¾ cup dehydrated refried bean flakes
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ cup shredded cheddar
- 8 corn tortillas
- 1 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Make beans with 1 cup boiling water; stir in salsa; top with cheese and microwave 1 minute.
2. Serve with baked tortilla chips (see Baked tortilla chips).

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 288 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 317 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 216 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 144 cal

Per adult serving: 288 cal · 11 g protein · 38 g carbs · 11 g fat · 8 g fiber · 595 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.83 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.62 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Warm cheese roll-ups

Snack · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Warm tortillas rolled around melty cheddar, ready in seconds.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 flour tortillas
- 1 cup shredded cheddar

Steps

1. Sprinkle cheese on tortillas; microwave 20 seconds; roll up.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 254 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 279 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 190 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 127 cal

Per adult serving: 254 cal · 11 g protein · 24 g carbs · 13 g fat · 1 g fiber · 525 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.53 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.55 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

White bean dip with veggies

Snack · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Silky garlic white bean dip with crunchy carrots and cucumber.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 can great northern beans, drained
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ½ tsp garlic powder *
- ¼ tsp salt
- 4 carrots
- 1 cucumber

Steps

1. Mash beans with oil, garlic powder, salt and 1–2 Tbsp water until smooth.
2. Serve with carrot and cucumber sticks.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 194 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 213 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 145 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 97 cal

Per adult serving: 194 cal · 7 g protein · 27 g carbs · 7 g fat · 8 g fiber · 537 mg sodium · 0 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.72 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.59 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Desserts

Apple crisp

Dessert · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Warm, tender cinnamon apples under a buttery, golden oat crumble.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 apples, sliced
- ¼ cup sugar
- 1½ tsp cinnamon
- 1 cup rolled oats
- ½ cup flour
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 6 Tbsp butter, melted

Steps

1. Toss apples with sugar and 1 tsp cinnamon in an 8x8 pan.
2. Mix oats, flour, brown sugar, the rest of the cinnamon and butter; crumble on top.
3. Bake at 350°F for 40 minutes, until bubbly.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 291 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 320 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 218 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 145 cal

Per adult serving: 291 cal · 3 g protein · 51 g carbs · 10 g fat · 4 g fiber · 74 mg sodium · 20 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.87 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.62 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Apple crisp (gluten-free and vegan)

Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Bubbling cinnamon apples under a crunchy oat topping, gluten-free and vegan.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 6 apples, sliced
- ¼ cup sugar
- 1½ tsp cinnamon
- 1 cup certified gluten-free oats *
- 3/8 cup gluten-free flour blend *
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 5 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Toss apples with sugar and 1 tsp cinnamon in an 8x8 pan.
2. Mix oats, flour, brown sugar, cinnamon and oil; crumble on top.
3. Bake at 350°F for 40 minutes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 279 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 307 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 209 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 140 cal

Per adult serving: 279 cal · 2 g protein · 49 g carbs · 10 g fat · 4 g fiber · 6 mg sodium · 20 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.90 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.63 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Banana pudding with cinnamon crisps

Dessert · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Layers of vanilla pudding, banana and crunchy cinnamon crisps.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box vanilla pudding mix
- 2 cups milk
- 3 bananas
- 4 slices white bread
- 2 Tbsp butter
- 3 tsp sugar
- ½ tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Make pudding with cold milk.
2. Cube bread; toss with melted butter, sugar and cinnamon; bake at 350°F for 12 minutes until crisp.
3. Layer pudding, banana slices and crisp cubes; chill 1 hour.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 207 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 227 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 155 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 103 cal

Per adult serving: 207 cal · 4 g protein · 38 g carbs · 5 g fat · 2 g fiber · 422 mg sodium · 16 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.95 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.42 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Bread pudding

Dessert · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Warm, custardy bread pudding with raisins and a hint of cinnamon.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 slices white bread, cubed
- 3 eggs
- 2 cups milk
- ½ cup sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp vanilla
- ½ cup raisins
- 2 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Spread bread and raisins in a buttered 8x8 pan.
2. Whisk eggs, milk, sugar, cinnamon, vanilla and melted butter; pour over; rest 15 minutes.
3. Bake at 350°F for 40–45 minutes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 239 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 263 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 179 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 120 cal

Per adult serving: 239 cal · 7 g protein · 38 g carbs · 7 g fat · 1 g fiber · 219 mg sodium · 15 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.69 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Brown sugar blondies

Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Chewy, buttery brown sugar bars with crackly, golden tops.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 8 Tbsp butter
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 1 egg
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 cup flour
- ½ tsp baking powder
- ¼ tsp salt

Steps

1. Mix melted butter and brown sugar; beat in egg and vanilla.
2. Stir in flour, baking powder and salt; spread in a greased 8x8 pan.
3. Bake at 350°F for 22–25 minutes.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 182 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 200 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 137 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 91 cal

Per adult serving: 182 cal · 2 g protein · 26 g carbs · 8 g fat · 0 g fiber · 139 mg sodium · 18 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.84 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.18 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Brownie pudding trifle

Dessert · Vegetarian

Layers of fudgy brownie, silky chocolate pudding and sweet banana.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box brownie mix
- 2 eggs
- 5 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 box chocolate pudding mix
- 2 cups milk
- 2 bananas

Steps

1. Bake brownies per the box; cool and cube.
2. Make pudding with cold milk.
3. Layer brownies, pudding and sliced bananas in a bowl; chill 1 hour.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 312 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 343 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 234 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 156 cal

Per adult serving: 312 cal · 4 g protein · 51 g carbs · 11 g fat · 2 g fiber · 373 mg sodium · 31 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.98 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.43 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Brownies

Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Fudgy, chewy brownies with crackly tops.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box brownie mix
- 2 eggs
- 5 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Mix per the box; bake in an 8x8 or 9x13 pan per the box.
2. Cool before cutting into 12.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 229 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 252 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 172 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 114 cal

Per adult serving: 229 cal · 3 g protein · 33 g carbs · 10 g fat · 1 g fiber · 153 mg sodium · 22 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.04 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.23 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chocolate cake

Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A moist, rich chocolate cake with a snowy dusting of powdered sugar.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box chocolate cake mix
- 3 eggs
- 8 Tbsp vegetable oil
- ¼ cup powdered sugar, for dusting

Steps

1. Mix per the box with eggs, oil and water.
2. Bake in a 9x13 pan per the box; cool.
3. Dust with powdered sugar.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 266 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 293 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 200 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 133 cal

Per adult serving: 266 cal · 3 g protein · 36 g carbs · 13 g fat · 1 g fiber · 268 mg sodium · 18 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.03 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.22 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chocolate cake with chocolate frosting

Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go

Moist chocolate cake covered in fluffy homemade chocolate frosting.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box chocolate cake mix
- 3 eggs
- 8 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 8 Tbsp butter
- 3 cups powdered sugar
- 3 servings hot cocoa mix
- ¼ cup milk
- 1 tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Bake cake per the box in a 9x13 pan; cool.
2. Beat soft butter with powdered sugar, hot cocoa mix, milk and vanilla until fluffy.
3. Spread over the cake.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 473 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 520 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 355 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 236 cal

Per adult serving: 473 cal · 4 g protein · 69 g carbs · 21 g fat · 1 g fiber · 368 mg sodium · 49 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.02 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.44 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chocolate pudding

Dessert · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Silky, rich chocolate pudding, ready in minutes.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box chocolate pudding mix
- 2 cups milk

Steps

1. Whisk mix into cold milk 2 minutes.
2. Spoon into cups; chill 5 minutes. Lidded cups pack well.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 131 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 144 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 98 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 65 cal

Per adult serving: 131 cal · 3 g protein · 26 g carbs · 2 g fat · 1 g fiber · 438 mg sodium · 18 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.50 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.33 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Chocolate pudding poke cake

Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go

Chocolate cake soaked with chocolate pudding for an extra-rich, fudgy bite.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box chocolate cake mix
- 3 eggs
- 8 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 box chocolate pudding mix
- 2 cups milk

Steps

1. Bake cake per the box in a 9x13 pan; poke holes with a spoon handle while warm.
2. Make pudding with cold milk; pour over the cake; chill 2 hours.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 322 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 354 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 241 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 161 cal

Per adult serving: 322 cal · 4 g protein · 46 g carbs · 14 g fat · 1 g fiber · 487 mg sodium · 25 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.74 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.38 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cinnamon baked apples

Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Tender baked apples filled with brown sugar, cinnamon and raisins.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 apples, cored
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup raisins
- 2 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Mix brown sugar, cinnamon, raisins and oil; fill the apples.
2. Set in a dish with ½ cup water; cover and bake at 375°F for 40 minutes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 239 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 263 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 179 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 120 cal

Per adult serving: 239 cal · 1 g protein · 47 g carbs · 7 g fat · 5 g fiber · 7 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.20 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.69 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Cinnamon-sugar skillet bananas

Dessert · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Warm bananas caramelized in butter, brown sugar and cinnamon.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 bananas, halved
- 2 Tbsp butter
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Melt butter with brown sugar and cinnamon.
2. Cook bananas 2 minutes per side, spooning sauce over.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 209 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 230 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 157 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 105 cal

Per adult serving: 209 cal · 1 g protein · 41 g carbs · 6 g fat · 3 g fiber · 50 mg sodium · 13 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.73 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.38 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Dairy-free chocolate pudding

Dessert · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Silky homemade chocolate pudding made with plant milk.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- ½ cup sugar
- 4 Tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder *
- ¼ cup flour
- 1/8 tsp salt
- 2½ cups soy or oat milk *
- 1 tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Whisk sugar, cocoa, flour and salt in a pot; slowly whisk in plant milk.
2. Cook over medium heat, whisking, until thick, about 8 minutes.
3. Stir in vanilla; chill.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 190 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 209 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 143 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 95 cal

Per adult serving: 190 cal · 6 g protein · 37 g carbs · 3 g fat · 3 g fiber · 129 mg sodium · 25 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.22 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.48 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Easy cinnamon apple cake

Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

A tender cinnamon cake studded with sweet diced apples.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box yellow cake mix
- 3 eggs
- 8 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 apples, diced
- 2 tsp cinnamon
- ½ cup powdered sugar

Steps

1. Mix cake per the box; fold in apples and cinnamon.
2. Bake in a 9x13 pan per the box, adding about 5 minutes.
3. Dust with powdered sugar.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 293 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 322 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 220 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 146 cal

Per adult serving: 293 cal · 3 g protein · 43 g carbs · 13 g fat · 1 g fiber · 268 mg sodium · 21 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.51 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.33 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Evaporated milk custard

Dessert · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Silky, sweet baked custard with vanilla and cinnamon.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 can evaporated milk
- 3 eggs
- ½ cup sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla
- ½ tsp cinnamon
- ½ cup milk

Steps

1. Whisk everything; pour into 6 cups set in a pan of hot water.
2. Bake at 325°F for 40 minutes, until set; chill.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 198 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 218 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 149 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 99 cal

Per adult serving: 198 cal · 8 g protein · 24 g carbs · 8 g fat · 0 g fiber · 111 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.80 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.39 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Flourless peanut butter cookies

Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Soft, chewy peanut butter cookies with a classic fork crisscross.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 16 Tbsp peanut butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 1 egg
- 1 tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Stir everything together.
2. Roll into 24 balls; press with a fork on a lined sheet.
3. Bake at 350°F for 10 minutes; cool on the pan. Serving = 2 cookies.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 198 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 218 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 149 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 99 cal

Per adult serving: 198 cal · 6 g protein · 21 g carbs · 11 g fat · 1 g fiber · 99 mg sodium · 18 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.71 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.15 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Jam shortcakes with vanilla yogurt

Dessert · Vegetarian · Lower-sugar pick

Sweet, flaky shortcakes split and filled with jam and creamy vanilla yogurt.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 3 tsp baking powder
- ¼ cup sugar
- ½ tsp salt
- 6 Tbsp butter
- ¾ cup milk
- 8 Tbsp strawberry jam
- 2 cups vanilla yogurt

Steps

1. Make sweet biscuit dough with flour, baking powder, sugar, salt, butter and milk; cut 8; bake at 425°F for 12 minutes.
2. Split warm shortcakes; fill with jam and yogurt.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 329 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 362 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 247 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 165 cal

Per adult serving: 329 cal · 7 g protein · 53 g carbs · 10 g fat · 1 g fiber · 449 mg sodium · 20 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.55 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.56 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Peach cobbler

Dessert · Vegetarian

Sweet peaches baked into a buttery, golden cobbler crust.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned peaches, drained
- 1 cup flour
- 1 cup sugar
- 2 tsp baking powder
- ¼ tsp salt
- 1 cup milk
- 8 Tbsp butter
- ½ tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Melt butter in a 9x13 pan in the 350°F oven.
2. Whisk flour, sugar, baking powder, salt and milk; pour over the butter without stirring.
3. Spoon peaches on top; sprinkle cinnamon. Bake 45 minutes, until golden.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 422 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 464 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 316 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 211 cal

Per adult serving: 422 cal · 4 g protein · 76 g carbs · 12 g fat · 2 g fiber · 312 mg sodium · 38 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.00 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.87 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Peach dump cake

Dessert · Vegetarian

Juicy peaches under a buttery, golden cake topping, about the easiest dessert there is.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned peaches, with syrup
- 1 box yellow cake mix
- 8 Tbsp butter
- 1 tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Pour peaches with syrup into a 9x13 pan.
2. Sprinkle dry cake mix evenly on top; drizzle with melted butter; sprinkle cinnamon.
3. Bake at 350°F for 45 minutes.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 327 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 360 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 245 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 163 cal

Per adult serving: 327 cal · 2 g protein · 59 g carbs · 10 g fat · 2 g fiber · 318 mg sodium · 24 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.91 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.63 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Peach oat crisp (vegan)

Dessert · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick

Juicy peaches under a crunchy cinnamon oat topping.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned peaches, drained
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 cup rolled oats
- ½ cup flour
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 5 Tbsp vegetable oil

Steps

1. Spread peaches in an 8x8 pan; sprinkle with half the cinnamon.
2. Mix oats, flour, brown sugar, cinnamon and oil; crumble on top.
3. Bake at 350°F for 30 minutes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 344 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 378 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 258 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 172 cal

Per adult serving: 344 cal · 3 g protein · 64 g carbs · 9 g fat · 3 g fiber · 17 mg sodium · 26 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.46 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.75 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Peanut butter banana soft-serve

Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy, frosty banana soft-serve swirled with peanut butter.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 4 bananas, sliced and frozen
- 3 Tbsp peanut butter
- 2 Tbsp pancake syrup

Steps

1. Blend frozen bananas with peanut butter and syrup until smooth.
2. Serve right away or freeze 30 minutes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 203 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 223 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 152 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 101 cal

Per adult serving: 203 cal · 4 g protein · 36 g carbs · 6 g fat · 4 g fiber · 62 mg sodium · 6 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.56 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.34 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pear crisp

Dessert · Vegetarian · Lower-sodium pick

Sweet pears baked under a buttery, golden oat crumble.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 2 cans canned pears, drained, sliced
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 cup rolled oats
- ½ cup flour
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 6 Tbsp butter

Steps

1. Spread pears in an 8x8 pan; sprinkle with half the cinnamon.
2. Mix oats, flour, brown sugar, cinnamon and melted butter; crumble on top.
3. Bake at 350°F for 30 minutes.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 345 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 380 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 259 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 173 cal

Per adult serving: 345 cal · 3 g protein · 64 g carbs · 9 g fat · 4 g fiber · 85 mg sodium · 26 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $3.76 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.82 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Pears with honey yogurt

Dessert · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Sweet pears topped with creamy yogurt, honey and a sprinkle of cinnamon.

Makes 4 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 can canned pears
- 1 cup vanilla yogurt
- 2 Tbsp honey
- ½ tsp cinnamon

Steps

1. Spoon drained pears into bowls.
2. Top with yogurt, honey and cinnamon.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 235 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 259 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 176 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 118 cal

Per adult serving: 235 cal · 3 g protein · 55 g carbs · 1 g fat · 3 g fiber · 51 mg sodium · 25 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $4.76 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $1.03 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Rice pudding

Dessert · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy, old-fashioned rice pudding with raisins, vanilla and cinnamon.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- ¾ cup rice (uncooked)
- 4 cups milk
- ½ cup sugar
- ½ cup raisins
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer rice in 1½ cups water 15 minutes.
2. Add milk, sugar, raisins and salt; simmer, stirring often, 25 minutes until creamy.
3. Stir in vanilla; sprinkle with cinnamon.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 275 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 303 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 206 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 138 cal

Per adult serving: 275 cal · 7 g protein · 55 g carbs · 4 g fat · 1 g fiber · 127 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.69 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.37 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Strawberry gelatin with bananas

Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Cool, jiggly strawberry gelatin with slices of sweet banana.

Makes 8 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box strawberry gelatin
- 2 bananas, sliced

Steps

1. Dissolve gelatin in boiling water per the box; add cold water.
2. Chill 1 hour, stir in banana slices, and chill until set.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 106 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 117 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 80 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 53 cal

Per adult serving: 106 cal · 2 g protein · 26 g carbs · 0 g fat · 1 g fiber · 100 mg sodium · 19 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.15 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.25 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Vanilla pudding with bananas

Dessert · Gluten-free · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy vanilla pudding layered with sweet banana slices.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box vanilla pudding mix
- 2 cups milk
- 2 bananas, sliced

Steps

1. Whisk mix into cold milk 2 minutes.
2. Layer with banana slices; chill.

To lower sugar: boxed mixes can't be changed; serve smaller portions.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 166 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 182 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 124 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 83 cal

Per adult serving: 166 cal · 3 g protein · 35 g carbs · 2 g fat · 1 g fiber · 439 mg sodium · 18 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.89 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.41 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Vegan chocolate wacky cake

Dessert · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

A moist, deeply chocolatey cake mixed right in the pan, no eggs or butter.

Makes 9 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1½ cups flour
- 1 cup sugar
- 3 Tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder *
- 1 tsp baking soda
- ½ tsp salt
- 5 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 Tbsp white vinegar *
- 1 tsp vanilla
- ¼ cup powdered sugar

Steps

1. Whisk flour, sugar, cocoa, baking soda and salt in an 8x8 pan.
2. Make three wells; pour oil, vinegar and vanilla into them; pour 1 cup water over all and stir smooth.
3. Bake at 350°F for 30–35 minutes. Dust with powdered sugar.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 247 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 272 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 185 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 124 cal

Per adult serving: 247 cal · 3 g protein · 42 g carbs · 8 g fat · 1 g fiber · 269 mg sodium · 25 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $0.79 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.17 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Vegan rice pudding

Dessert · Gluten-free · Dairy-free · Vegan · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick · Lower-sugar pick

Creamy rice pudding with raisins and cinnamon, made with plant milk.

Makes 6 adult servings

Ingredients

- ¾ cup rice (uncooked)
- 4 cups soy or oat milk *
- ½ cup sugar
- ½ cup raisins
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1/8 tsp salt

Steps

1. Simmer rice in 1½ cups water 15 minutes.
2. Add plant milk, sugar, raisins and salt; simmer, stirring, 25 minutes.
3. Stir in vanilla; sprinkle with cinnamon.

To lower sodium: use half the salt and bouillon, a third less soy sauce or taco seasoning, and drain and rinse canned beans and vegetables.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 247 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 272 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 185 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 124 cal

Per adult serving: 247 cal · 7 g protein · 49 g carbs · 3 g fat · 2 g fiber · 111 mg sodium · 17 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $2.30 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.50 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Yellow cake with powdered-sugar glaze

Dessert · Vegetarian · Packs to go · Lower-sodium pick

Tender, buttery yellow cake drizzled with a sweet vanilla glaze.

Makes 12 adult servings

Ingredients

- 1 box yellow cake mix
- 3 eggs
- 8 Tbsp vegetable oil
- 1½ cups powdered sugar
- 3 Tbsp milk
- ½ tsp vanilla

Steps

1. Mix and bake per the box in a 9x13 pan; cool.
2. Whisk powdered sugar, milk and vanilla smooth; drizzle over the cake.

To lower sugar: use a third less sugar, syrup, honey or jam.

Serving size by age, with estimated calories per portion

Adult 1 serving = 318 cal · Teen 1.1 servings = 349 cal · Child 3/4 serving = 238 cal · Toddler 1/2 serving = 159 cal

Per adult serving: 318 cal · 3 g protein · 49 g carbs · 13 g fat · 0 g fiber · 270 mg sodium · 30 g added sugar (estimated)

Estimated cost: $1.22 for a family of 2 adults, 1 teen and 2 children (4.6 servings), about $0.27 per adult serving, at estimated October 2026 prices. For planning purposes only; see page 2.

Lower-sodium picks (142)

Recipes with no more sodium per serving than the planner's cutoff for their meal type. Estimates only; amounts do not include the Lower sodium changes.

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Apple crisp (gluten-free and vegan) 169
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